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### Zero-trust distributed data sharing

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#### Abstract

A decryption key is recovered that is utilized to decrypt an encrypted resource. For example, a determination is made as to whether a user and/or the user's computing device attempting to access an encrypted resource has the necessary attributes to access the resource and/or is in a valid location in which the user is required to be to access the resource. The attributes and/or location are defined by a policy assigned to the resource. To verify that the user has the required attributes, a proof is requested from the user that proves that the user has the required attributes. Upon validating the proof, the decryption key is generated and/or retrieved.

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## **Background/Summary**

### **BACKGROUND**

(1) Public-key cryptography (also known as asymmetric cryptography) is a cryptographic system that uses pairs of keys. Each pair consists of a public key (which is known to others) and a private key (which is only known to the owner). Effective security requires keeping the private key private, whereas the public key can be openly distributed.

### **SUMMARY**

(2) This Summary is provided to introduce a selection of concepts in a simplified form that are further described below in the Detailed Description. This Summary is not intended to identify key features or essential features of the claimed subject matter, nor is it intended to be used to limit the scope of the claimed subject matter.

(3) In aspects disclosed herein, a decryption key is recovered to decrypt an encrypted resource via zero-trust distributed data sharing. For example, a determination is made as to whether a user and/or the user's computing device attempting to access an encrypted resource has the necessary attributes to access the resource and/or is in a valid location in which the user is required to be to access the resource. The attributes and/or location are defined by a policy assigned to the resource. To verify that the user has the required attributes, a proof is requested from the user that proves that the user has the required attributes. Upon validating the proof, the decryption key is generated and/or retrieved.

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## **Description**

### **BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS/FIGURES**

(1) The accompanying drawings, which are incorporated herein and form a part of the specification, illustrate embodiments of the present application and, together with the description, further serve to explain the principles of the embodiments and to enable a person skilled in the pertinent art to make and use the embodiments.

(2) FIG. 1 shows a block diagram of an example system for recovering a decryption key in accordance with an example embodiment.

(3) FIG. 2 depicts a block diagram of a ledger database in accordance with an example embodiment.

(4) FIG. 3 depicts a block diagram of a system for obtaining a decryption key in accordance with an embodiment.

(5) FIG. 4 shows a flowchart for obtaining a decryption key in accordance with an embodiment.

(6) FIG. 5 shows a flowchart for decrypting a resource in accordance with an example embodiment.

(7) FIG. 6 depicts a block diagram of a system for decrypting a resource in accordance with an example embodiment.

(8) FIG. 7 shows a flowchart for encrypting a decryption key using a public encryption key of the

user in accordance with an example embodiment.

(9) FIG. 8 depicts a block diagram of a system for encrypting a decryption key using a public encryption key of the user in accordance with an example embodiment.

(10) FIG. 9 shows a flowchart for verifying that a user is associated with an identity in accordance with an example embodiment.

(11) FIG. 10 depicts a block diagram of a system for verifying that a user is associated with an identity in accordance with an example embodiment.

(12) FIG. 11 depicts a block diagram of a system for obtaining a decryption key in accordance with another embodiment.

(13) FIG. 12 shows a flowchart for obtaining a decryption key in accordance with another example embodiment.

(14) FIG. 13 depicts a block diagram of a system for generating a decryption key in accordance with an example embodiment.

(15) FIG. 14 shows a flowchart for generating a decryption key in accordance with an example embodiment.

(16) FIG. 15 shows a block diagram of an example computer system in which embodiments may be implemented.

(17) The subject matter of the present application will now be described with reference to the accompanying drawings. In the drawings, like reference numbers indicate identical or functionally similar elements. Additionally, the left-most digit(s) of a reference number identifies the drawing in which the reference number first appears.

## DETAILED DESCRIPTION

### I. Introduction

(18) The following detailed description discloses numerous example embodiments. The scope of the present patent application is not limited to the disclosed embodiments, but also encompasses combinations of the disclosed embodiments, as well as modifications to the disclosed embodiments. It is noted that any section/subsection headings provided herein are not intended to be limiting. Embodiments are described throughout this document, and any type of embodiment may be included under any section/subsection. Furthermore, embodiments disclosed in any section/subsection may be combined with any other embodiments described in the same section/subsection and/or a different section/subsection in any manner.

### II. Example Embodiments

(19) A potential security vulnerability arises when access policies for accessing encrypted resources are enforced by trusted components of an organization (e.g., components of a particular organization or network that are assumed to be secure) that maintain the resources. If a malicious entity manages to infiltrate such resources, the malicious entity is free to move laterally and access or exfiltrate sensitive data.

(20) Embodiments are described herein are directed to recovering a decryption key utilized to decrypt an encrypted resource via a zero-trust distributed architecture. For example, a determination is made as to whether a user and/or the user's computing device attempting to access an encrypted resource has the necessary attributes to access the resource and/or is in a valid location in which the user is required to be to access the resource. The attributes and/or location are defined by a policy assigned to the resource. To verify that the user has the required attributes, a proof is requested from the user that proves that the user has the required attributes. Upon validating the proof, the decryption key is generated and/or retrieved.

(21) The techniques described herein provide cryptographic enforcement, in a zero-trust model (and other models), end-to-end across various types of data, services, and organizations. In particular, one or more components (e.g., component(s) that perform policy verification, proof verification, and/or key recovery) may not be considered as “trusted.” Such untrusted components are not entrusted to store sensitive data, such as decryption keys, due to a risk of the sensitive data

being compromised thereon. Instead, such component(s) simply maintain the necessary information to release such keys.

(22) Accordingly, the techniques described herein advantageously provide improvements in other technologies, namely data encryption, security, and privacy. For instance, by utilizing a zero-trust model, access to sensitive data, such as decryption keys, is made available only to users and environments that meet policy requirements, and is prevented to all other users and environments, including the administrators of the systems and services that enforce policy. By doing so, the techniques described herein also prevent access to a user's network and computing entities (e.g., computing devices, virtual machines, etc.). By mitigating the access to such computing entities, the unnecessary expenditure of compute resources (e.g., central processing units (CPUs), storage devices, memory, power, etc.) associated with such entities is also mitigated. Accordingly, the embodiments described herein also improve the functioning of the computing entity on which such compute resources are utilized/maintained, as such compute resources are conserved as a result from preventing a malicious entity from utilizing such compute resources, e.g., for nefarious purposes.

(23) FIG. 1 shows a block diagram of an example system **100** for recovering a decryption key, according to an example embodiment. As shown in FIG. 1, system **100** includes a computing device **102**, an orchestrator **104**, a data source **106**, and one or more database (DB) hosts **116**. DB host(s) **116** comprise one or more server computers or computing devices, which include one or more distributed or “cloud-based” servers, in embodiments. In embodiments, DB host(s) **116** are associated with, or are a part of, a cloud-based service platform and in some embodiments, DB host(s) **116** comprise one or more on-premises servers in addition to, or in lieu of, cloud-based server(s). DB host(s) **116** are configured to host and execute any type of DB server application, such as but not limited to, Azure SQL Database™ from Microsoft Corporation of Redmond, WA. In embodiments, computing device **102**, DB hosts(s) **116**, orchestrator **104**, and/or data source **106**, are communicatively coupled via one or more networks **114**, comprising one or more of local area networks (LANs), wide area networks (WANs), enterprise networks, the Internet, etc., and includes one or more of wired and/or wireless portions. Computing device **102** is any type of processing device, including, but not limited to, a desktop computer, a server, a mobile or handheld device (e.g., a tablet, a personal data assistant (PDA), a smart phone, a laptop, etc.), an Internet-of-Things (IoT) device, etc. Orchestrator **104** comprises one or more server computers or computing devices, which include one or more distributed or “cloud-based” servers, in embodiments. In embodiments, orchestrator **104** is associated with, or are a part of, a cloud-based service platform and in some embodiments, orchestrator **104** comprises on-premises server(s) in addition to, or in lieu of, cloud-based servers.

(24) As shown in FIG. 1, DB host(s) **116** execute a ledger database **120**. Ledger database **120** provides tamper-evidence capabilities for database tables of ledger database **120** (referred to as ledger tables), where one can cryptographically attest to other parties, such as auditors or other parties that the data maintained by the database has not been tampered with. Ledger database **120** protects data from any attacker or high-privileged user, including database administrators, system administrators, and cloud administrators. As with a traditional ledger, historical data is preserved. If a row is updated in a ledger table, its previous value is maintained and protected in a history table. Ledger database **120** provides a chronicle of all changes made to the database over time. In accordance with an embodiment, historical data is maintained in a relational form to support queries (e.g., SQL queries) for auditing, forensics, and other purposes.

(25) Any rows modified by a transaction in a ledger table is cryptographically hashed (e.g., SHA-256 hashed) using a data structure, such as a Merkle tree, that creates a root hash representing all rows in the transaction. The transactions that ledger database **120** processes are then also hashed together through another Merkle tree data structure. The result is a root hash that forms a block. The block is then hashed through the root hash of the block, along with the root hash of the

previous block as input to the hash function. That hashing forms a blockchain. The root hashes, also referred herein as database digests, contain the cryptographically hashed transactions and represent the state of the database at the time the digests were generated. In accordance with an embodiment, the digests are periodically generated and stored outside the database in tamper-proof storage. Digests are later used to verify the integrity of the database by comparing the value of the hash in the digest against the calculated hashes in database.

(26) Materialized views of ledger tables are generated in fixed periodic intervals referred to as epochs. Ledger database **120** is also configured to provide forward integrity, which guarantees that given a materialized view of a ledger table at any time  $t$ , it is infeasible to tamper the ledger table in any subsequent epoch.

(27) Ledger database **120** is configured to store and protect any type of data or information, including, but not limited to a verifiable identity map **108**, a verifiable attribute map **110**, and a verifiable policy map **112**. Identity map **108** is configured to store an identity for each of a plurality of users (e.g., members, employees, etc.), for example, of an organization. Each identity comprises information that uniquely identifies the user within the organization. Examples of the identity include, but are not limited to, the user's email address, the user's phone number, the user's username, or any other type of information that uniquely identifies the user. Identity map **108** is also configured to store, for each user, a public signing key of the user in association with the identity of the user, and/or a public encryption key of the user in association with the identity of the user.

(28) Attribute map **110** is configured to store one or more attributes for each of a plurality of users of the organization. Each of the attribute(s) for a particular user are stored in association with the identity of that user. Examples of attribute(s) include, but are not limited to, a security clearance level of the user (e.g., confidential, secret, top secret, top secret special access etc.), a rank (e.g., lieutenant, captain, major, colonel, etc.) of the user within an organization (e.g., such as a military organization), a role of the user within an organization (e.g., a field agent, an analyst, a manager, a director, a chief technology officer, a chief executive officer, etc.), etc. Attribute map **110** is also configured to store, for each user, one or more encrypted shared secrets (e.g., one or more pieces of data, such as a password, a private key, a public key, a string of characters and/or random numbers, etc. that are encoded in accordance with an encryption technique, such as, but not limited to, an advanced encryption standard (AES)-based technique). Each of the shared secret(s) for a particular user are stored in association with the identity of that user. Attribute map **110** also associates each encrypted shared secret with a corresponding attribute of the attributes stored in attribute map **110**. As described below, the encrypted shared secret(s) are utilized to verify whether a user is actually associated with corresponding attributes. In accordance with an embodiment, the shared secret(s) of a user stored in attribute map **110** are encrypted with a private encryption key of that user. Attribute map **110** is also configured to store, for each attribute, a public encryption key, which, as will be described below, is utilized to generate and verify cryptographic proofs. Attribute map **110** associates each public encryption key with a corresponding attribute and corresponding encrypted secret share of the attributes stored in attribute map **110**.

(29) Policy map **112** is configured to store one or more policies for resources (e.g., accessible pieces of data on which one or more operations can be performed) maintained by data source **106**. Each of the polic(ies) specify one or more conditions that are required to be satisfied for a user to perform a certain action with respect to a corresponding resource. Policy map **112** associates each of the polic(ies) with a policy identifier (ID), which uniquely identifies a corresponding policy. Such actions include, but are not limited to, the releasing of a decryption key, accessing a resource (e.g., reading or writing to a resource) via the released decryption key, sending the resource to another user, sending a communication to another user, etc. The conditions include, but are not limited to, a particular identity of a particular user authorized to perform the action, particular attributes that the identity (or user) and/or the user's computing device or environment is required

to have to perform the action, a location at which the user (and/or a computing device associated therewith) is required to be to perform the action, and/or the like. Examples of resources include, but are not limited to, a data file (e.g., a document), a database object (e.g., a table, a directory, etc.), structured data, unstructured data, semi-structured data, a data container, etc. Examples of locations include, but are not limited to, a particular room or building, a particular vehicle or vessel (e.g., a particular car, a particular submarine, a particular aircraft carrier, etc.), a particular city, a particular country, etc.

(30) To initially generate identity map **108**, the organization obtains the identities of its members and stores the identities in a column of identity map **108** configured to store identities. The organization also obtains the public signing keys of its members and stores the long-term public signing keys in a column **116** of identity map **108** configured to store long-term public signing keys.

(31) The organization signs identity map **108**, attribute map **110**, and/or policy map **112** using its own private signing key. Identity map **108**, attribute map **110**, and/or policy map **112** are considered to be trusted and verifiable, as the binding between respective identities and long-term public signing keys is signed by the private signing key of the organization and is verifiable using the public signing key corresponding to the private signing key of the organization. It is noted that an organization may publish an identity map, attribute map, and/or policy map that refers to identities, attributes, and/or policies, respectively, published by other organizations.

(32) Ledger database **120** is configured to provide users of identity map **108**, attribute map and/or policy map **112** (e.g., the user of computing device **102**) access to a digest, which is representative of the state of ledger database **120** (including identity map **108**, attribute map, and policy map **112**). For example, as shown in FIG. 1, computing device **102** may store the digest. It is noted that in embodiments, ledger database **120** is configured to provide access to some or all of the digests that are generated by ledger database **120** over time.

(33) FIG. 2 depicts a block diagram of a ledger database **200** in accordance with an example embodiment. Ledger database **200** is an example of ledger database **120**, as described above with reference to FIG. 1. As shown in FIG. 2, ledger database **200** comprises at least a current (or updateable) ledger table **202**, a history table **204**, and a ledger **206**.

(34) Current table **202** includes entries (or rows) of data, each entry having a number of columns. Current table **202** exemplarily includes, for illustrative purposes, an identity map, an attribute map **110** and/or a policy map **112** (e.g., identity map **108**, attribute map **110**, and/or policy map **112**, as shown in FIG. 1). Likewise, history table **204** includes similar, or the same, columns for rows of entries therein, but the rows of history table **204** include data reflecting each transaction that changes data in current table **202** (e.g., modify, delete, etc.). For example, if a row is updated in the database, its previous value is maintained and protected in history table **204**.

(35) Ledger **206** is a cryptographic data structure that comprises a blockchain. Ledger **206** includes a number of blocks having block IDs: a genesis block **208** (ID 'Block 0'), a first block **210** (ID 'Block 1'), etc., up to a current block **212** (ID 'Block N-1'), and it should be noted that additional blocks such as a future block **214** (ID 'Block N') may be generated for maintenance of the blockchain as additional entries are changed in current table **202** and prior entries are reflected in history table **204**. Each block of the blockchain of ledger **206** includes at least a block ID, a hash value of the immediately preceding block (e.g., a SHA-256-based hash), and a root hash value representative of all the rows of the database post-update (e.g., a SHA-256 hash generated via a Merkle tree data structure), according to embodiments.

(36) In the initial state of ledger **206**, genesis block **208** (ID Block '0') has no meaningful prior hash value (zero) stored. However, after some time period in which transactions affect entries in current table **202** and history table **204**, first block **210** (ID 'Block 1') is generated and completed which stores the hash value over 'Block 0'.

(37) The root hash value of the latest block (e.g., current block **212**) in ledger **206** is referred to as a

digest (shown as digest **218**), which captures a validity state of current table **202**, history table **204**, and ledger **206**. In this way, a single hash value, e.g., in digest **218**, enables verification to be performed on data in the database, e.g., in current table **202**, history table **204**, and ledger **206**, that was present at and before generation of digest **218**. Digest **218** is stored in secure storage and/or published (e.g., via a website) for use by users of computing devices **102A-102N** (as shown in FIG. **1**).

(38) As an example, suppose Block N-2 is the current block in ledger **206** and a transaction is received to update current table **202**. In this example, history table **204** is updated to store the information stored in current table **202**, and current table **202** is updated in accordance with the transaction. A new block in ledger **206** for the transaction is generated (e.g., current block **212**). A transaction hash value **216** is then generated over the entry in history table **204** and a changed entry in current table **202** that is generated by the transaction that was performed on the entry.

Transaction hash value **216** is inserted into block **212**. To generate the root hash value, the updated rows are inserted as leaf nodes of a hierarchical hash data structure, such as a Merkle tree. Each leaf node is then hashed (e.g., SHA-256 hashed) to generate a hash value for the leaf nodes. For each node that is not a leaf, a hash value is generated therefor that is based on the hash values of its child nodes. A root hash value of the hierarchical hash data structure (e.g., a root hash value of the root node of the hierarchical hash data structure) is then determined based on the hash values of its child nodes and utilized as the root hash value (and digest **218**) stored in current block **212**.

(39) It is noted that any given block comprises any number of transactions. A new block is generated responsive to one or more events, including, but not limited to, expiry of a predetermined time period (e.g., 30 seconds), when a block reaches a maximum number of transactions (e.g., 100,000), etc.

(40) Additionally, with respect to FIG. **2**, embodiments provide for a view of a ledger (i.e., a ledger view table **220**) that comprises a union of current table **202** and history table **204**. Ledger view table **220** is queryable or otherwise operable via database operations and thus, provides a consolidate view of the current state of the data as well as all transactions previously performed on the current table.

(41) Referring again to FIG. **1**, in accordance with one or more embodiments, each of identity map **108**, attribute map **110**, and policy map **112** are maintained in a respective table of a database. For example, with respect to identity map **108**, a first column of identity map **108** stores user identities, a second column stores public signing keys, a third column stores public encryption keys, etc. With respect to attribute map **110**, a first column of attribute map **110** stores user identities, a second column stores first attributes, a third column stores second attributes, a fourth column stores first encrypted shared secrets associated with the first attributes, a fifth column stores second encrypted shared secrets associated with the second attributes, a sixth column stores a first public encryption key associated with the first attributes and/or first encrypted shared secrets, a seventh column stores a second public encryption key associated with the second attributes and/or second encrypted shared secrets, etc. With respect to policy map **112**, a first column stores policy IDs, a second column stores the policies, etc.

(42) In accordance with one or more embodiments, one or more columns of identity map **108**, attribute map **110**, and/or policy map **112** are maintained together in a single table of a database. An example of a database via which identity map **108**, attribute map **110**, and/or policy map **112** are maintained includes, but is not limited to, Azure SQL Database™ from Microsoft® Corporation of Redmond, Washington.

(43) As also shown in FIG. **1**, computing device **102** comprises an application **118**. Application **118** is any software application that is utilized to access a resource, encrypt a resource, and/or decrypt a resource. Examples of application **118**, but are not limited to, a messaging application (e.g., Microsoft Teams™ published by Microsoft Corporation of Redmond, WA), a word processing application (e.g., Microsoft Word™ published by Microsoft Corporation), a database application,

etc.

(44) Application **118** is configured to access a resource, for example, maintained by data source **106**. Data source **106** also comprises a policy ID specified for each resource maintained thereby. In accordance with an embodiment, the policy ID is stored as metadata associated with the resource. Examples of data source **106** include, but are not limited to, a data store, a file repository, a database, etc. The resource may be encrypted (e.g., the resource is encoded in accordance with an encryption technique, such as, but not limited to, an AES-based technique). In such a case, application **118** requires the resource to be decrypted (e.g., decoded in accordance with a decryption technique, such as, but not limited to, an AES-based technique), for example, using a decryption key, in order to access it. The decryption key is released if a policy (e.g., an access policy) associated with the resource is satisfied, thereby enabling the resource to be decrypted.

(45) Orchestrator **104** is configured to facilitate a determination as to whether the policy for a resource attempted to be accessed by application **118** is satisfied. For example, orchestrator facilitates the determination as to whether the user has the necessary attributes and/or is at a location specified by the policy. Upon determining that the policy is satisfied, orchestrator **104** obtains (or recovers) the decryption key and/or provides the decryption key to application **118**, which decrypts the resource. Alternatively, orchestrator **104** (or another component coupled thereto) decrypts the resource using the decryption key, and the decrypted resource is provided to application **118**.

(46) Additional details regarding recovering the decryption key is provided below. In particular, Subsection A describes an embodiment in which orchestrator **104** is trusted to properly evaluate the policy and obtains the decryption key from a trusted key manager. Subsection B describes an embodiment in which orchestrator **104** is untrusted to properly evaluate the policy and obtains the decryption key from a trusted key manager. Here, an untrusted location attribute policy (LAP) server is configured to evaluate the policy. Subsection C describes an embodiment in which an untrusted LAP server is configured to fully evaluate the policy and obtains the decryption key from an untrusted key generator.

(47) A. Key Provision Via a Trusted Orchestrator and Key Manager

(48) FIG. 3 depicts a block diagram of a system **300** for obtaining a decryption key in accordance with an embodiment. As shown in FIG. 3, system **300** includes computing device **102**, orchestrator **104**, data source **106**, identity map **108**, attribute map **110**, policy map **112**, and a key manager **302**, which stores one or more decryption keys (e.g., decryption key **316**) for decrypting resources stored by data source **106**. In accordance with an embodiment, key manager **302** is included as part of orchestrator **104**. In accordance with another embodiment, key manager **302** comprises server computer(s) or computing device(s), which include one or more distributed or “cloud-based” servers, in embodiments. In embodiments, key manager **302** is associated with, or are a part of, a cloud-based service platform and in some embodiments, key manager **302** comprises on-premises server(s) in addition to, or in lieu of, cloud-based servers. As further shown in FIG. 3, orchestrator **104** comprise a data retriever **304** and a verifier **306**. Computing device **102** comprises application **118**, a decryptor **308**, and a private encryption key **310**.

(49) To request a resource, application **118** provides a request **312** identifying the resource to data source **106**. Data source **106** is configured to return a response **314** including the encrypted resource and/or specifying at least the policy ID that identifies the policy associated with the requested resource and/or an organization that specifies and/or maintains the policy.

(50) Application **118** provides the policy ID to orchestrator **104** via a request **316**. In accordance with an embodiment, various organizations maintain respective orchestrators, each configured to determine a policy for resources associated therewith. In accordance with an embodiment, the organization identified via response **314** is a uniform resource identifier (URI) (e.g., a uniform resource locator (URL)), or an identifier utilized to lookup the URI, at which an orchestrator of the organization and/or an identity map, attribute map, and/or policy map associated with the

organization are located. In accordance with such an embodiment, response **314** is provided to the orchestrator corresponding to the URI thereof.

(51) Data retriever **304** is configured to provide a request **318** to policy map **112** associated with the organization that specifies the policy ID. Policy map **112** looks up the policy associated with policy ID and returns the policy to data retriever **304** via a response **320**. Data retriever **304** analyzes the policy to determine the identit(ies) and/or attribute(s) that are required to access the resource requested by application **118**. For instance, the policy specifies an identity at the organization that is allowed to access the resource, specifies that the user requires a first attribute (e.g., the user is required to have a rank level of captain), a second attribute (the user is required to have a top secret security clearance level, and/or location information that specifies that the user must be in a particular location (e.g., aboard a particular submarine) to access the resource. Data retriever **304** provides the determined identit(ies) and/or attribute(s) to verifier **306**.

(52) Verifier **306** is configured to determine whether the user has the proper identity. For instance, verifier **306** requests application **118** to prove that the user has the proper identity. In accordance with an embodiment, to prove the user's identity, verifier **306** first provides a request **322** to application **118** for the user's identity (e.g., username, email address, etc.). Application **118** provides verifier **306** the user's identity via a response **324**. Responsive to receiving response **324**, verifier **306** retrieves the public encryption key associated with the identity from identity map **108**. It is noted that the techniques described herein to prove a user's identity are purely exemplary and that other techniques may be utilized to prove a user's identity.

(53) Verifier **306** then generates a nonce (e.g., a randomly-generated number intended to prevent replay attacks) and encrypts the nonce using the public encryption key associated with the identity. Verifier **306** also maintains a copy of the nonce. Verifier **306** provides the encrypted nonce to computing device **102** via a request **326**.

(54) Decryptor **308** of computing device **102** is configured to decrypt the nonce using private encryption key **310** and provides the decrypted nonce to verifier **306** via a response **328**. In accordance with an embodiment, decryptor **308** is a separate component (e.g., a software application, a hardware-based cryptoprocessor, etc.) from application **118** (as shown in FIG. 1). In accordance with another embodiment, decryptor **308** is incorporated in application **118**. Private encryption key **310** is stored locally in a secure environment of computing device **102**. Examples of a secure environment include, but are not limited to, a trusted platform module (TPM), a hardware security module (HSM), or any type of secure hardware and/or software-based cryptoprocessor.

(55) Verifier **306** is configured to compare the decrypted nonce to the locally-stored nonce. If the nonces match, then verifier **306** determines that the user has the proper identity. Otherwise, verifier **306** determines that the user does not have the proper identity and access to the encrypted resource is denied.

(56) To determine that the user has the proper attributes, verifier **306** retrieves the attribute(s) associated with the identity in attribute map **110** and compares the retrieved attributes to the attributes of the policy received by data retriever **304**. If the attributes match, then verifier **306** sends a request **330** for the decryption key (e.g., decryption key **316**) associated with the resource to key manager **302**. For instance, request **330** may specify a resource identifier that uniquely identifies the resource and that is associated with the corresponding decryption key. Key manager **302** returns the decryption key (e.g., decryption key **316**) corresponding to the resource to verifier **306** via a response **332**.

(57) In accordance with an embodiment, verifier **306** provides decryption key **316** to decryptor **308**, and decryptor **308** decrypts the resource for application **118**. In accordance with another embodiment, key manager **302** encrypts decryption key **316** using the public encryption key of an entity (e.g., the user (as stored in identity map **108**) the user's application (e.g., application **118**), a document management and storage system (e.g., Microsoft SharePoint™ published by Microsoft® Corp.) that is to decrypt the resource, etc.). The public encryption key is retrieved from identity

map **108**. In accordance with such an embodiment, verifier **306** sends the encrypted decryption key to the entity (e.g., application **118**). Decryptor **308** then decrypts the encrypted decryption key using the private encryption key (e.g., private key **310**) corresponding to the public encryption key. By doing so, decryption key **316** is protected from rogue users that may intercept communications between orchestrator **104** and computing device **102**. In accordance with a further embodiment, orchestrator **104** comprises a decryptor that decrypts the resource, and orchestrator **104** provides the decrypted resource to application **118**. This way, application **118** is not required to perform the decryption.

(58) In accordance with the techniques described in this subsection, orchestrator **104** is trusted to properly evaluate the policy to access the resource, and key manager **302** is trusted to store decryption key **316**.

(59) Accordingly, a decryption key is obtained in many ways. For example, FIG. **4** shows a flowchart **400** for obtaining a decryption key, according to an example embodiment. In an embodiment, flowchart **400** is implemented by system **300**, as shown in FIG. **3**. Accordingly, flowchart **400** will be described with continued reference to FIG. **3**. Other structural and operational embodiments will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art(s) based on the following discussion regarding flowchart **400** and system **300** of FIG. **3**.

(60) Flowchart **400** begins with step **402**. In step **402**, a request, from a computing device of a user, is received for decrypting a resource. The request specifies a policy identifier of a policy that specifies an identity authorized to access the resource and a first attribute required to access the resource. For example, with reference to FIG. **3**, data retriever **304** of orchestrator **104** receives request **316** from application **118** of computing device **102** for decrypting a resource stored in data source **106**. Request **316** specifies a policy identifier of a policy that specifies an identity authorized to access the resource and a first attribute required to access the resource.

(61) In accordance with one or more embodiments, the first attribute comprises at least one of a clearance level of the user, a rank of the user within an organization, or a role of the user within the organization.

(62) In accordance with one or more embodiments, the resource comprises at least one of a data file, a database object, structured data, unstructured data, or a data container.

(63) In step **404**, the policy corresponding to the policy identifier is obtained from a policy map maintained by a ledger database. For example, with reference to FIG. **3**, data retriever **304** obtains the policy corresponding to the policy identifier from policy map **112** maintained by ledger database **120** (as described above with reference to FIG. **1**). For instance, data retriever **304** provides request **318** specifying the policy identifier to policy map **112**. Policy map **112** looks up the policy using the policy identifier and returns the policy to data retriever **304** via response **320**.

(64) In step **406**, the identity authorized to access the resource and the first attribute required to access the resource is determined based on the policy. For example, with reference to FIG. **3**, data retriever **304** analyzes the policy to determine the identity authorized to access the resource and the first attribute required to access the resource.

(65) In step **408**, a verification is made that the user is associated with the identity. For example, with reference to FIG. **3**, verifier **306** verifies that the user is associated with the identity. Additional details regarding verifying that the user is associated with the identity is provided below with reference to FIGS. **9** and **10**.

(66) In step **410**, responsive to verifying that the user is associated with the identity, a second attribute of the user is obtained from an attribute map maintained by the ledger database. For example, with reference to FIG. **3**, responsive to verifying that the user is associated with the identity, verifier **306** obtains a second attribute of the user from attribute map **110** maintained by ledger database **120** (as described above with reference to FIG. **1**). For instance, verifier **306** provides a request specifying the user's identity to attribute map **110**. Attribute map **110** looks up the identity's attribute(s) and provides the attribute(s) to verifier **306** via a response.

(67) In step **412**, a determination is made that the second attribute is the same as the first attribute. For example, with reference to FIG. 3, verifier **306** determines that the second attribute is the same as the first attribute.

(68) In step **414**, responsive to determining that second attribute is the same as the first attribute, a decryption key for decrypting the resource is obtained. For example, with reference to FIG. 3, verifier **306** provides request **330** to key manager **302**. Key manager **302** returns decryption key **316** for decrypting the resource to verifier **306** via response **332**.

(69) In accordance with one or more embodiments, the resource is decrypted using the decryption key and provided to the requesting application. For example, FIG. 5 shows a flowchart **500** for decrypting a resource, according to an example embodiment. In an embodiment, flowchart **500** is implemented by a system **600**, as shown in FIG. 6. Accordingly, flowchart **500** will be described with reference to FIG. 6. FIG. 6 depicts a block diagram of a system **600** for decrypting a resource at an orchestrator (e.g., orchestrator **104**, as shown in FIG. 3) in accordance with an example embodiment. As shown in FIG. 6, system **600** comprises a decryptor **606** and an application **618**. Decryptor **606** is configured to execute on a key manager (e.g., key manager **302**, as shown in FIG. 3). Application **618** is an example of application **118**, as described above with reference to FIG. 3, and is configured to execute on a user's computing device (e.g., computing device **102**, as described above with reference to FIG. 1). Other structural and operational embodiments will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art(s) based on the following discussion regarding flowchart **500** and system **600** of FIG. 6.

(70) Flowchart **500** begins with step **502**. In step **502**, the resource is decrypted utilizing the decryption key. For example, with reference to FIG. 6, decryptor **606** is configured to decrypt the resource (shown as resource **602**) using a decryption key **616**. Decryption key **616** is an example of decryption key **316**, as described above with reference to FIG. 3. In accordance with an embodiment, decryptor **606** is configured to receive resource **602** from application **618**. For instance, when retrieving the resource from a data source (e.g., data source, as described above with reference to FIG. 3), the data source returns the encrypted resource to application **618**, and application **618** provides the encrypted resource to orchestrator **104** along with the policy ID associated with the resource (e.g., via request **316**, as described above with reference to FIG. 3).

(71) In step **504**, the encrypted resource is provided to a computing device associated with the user. For example, with reference to FIG. 6, decryptor **606** provides the decrypted resource (shown as decrypted resource **604**) to application **618**, which executes on a computing device (e.g., computing device **102**, as described above with reference to FIG. 2).

(72) In accordance with one or more embodiments, the decryption key is encrypted with a public encryption key of the user. For example, FIG. 7 shows a flowchart **700** for encrypting a decryption key using a public encryption key of the user in accordance with an example embodiment. In an embodiment, flowchart **700** is implemented by a system **800**, as shown in FIG. 8. Accordingly, flowchart **700** will be described with reference to FIG. 8. FIG. 8 depicts a block diagram of a system **800** for encrypting a decryption key using a public encryption key of the user in accordance with an example embodiment. As shown in FIG. 8, system **800** comprises an encryptor **802** and an application **818**. Encryptor **802** is configured to be executed by key manager **302** (as shown in FIG. 3). Application **818** is an example of application **118**, as described above with reference to FIG. 3, and is configured to execute on a user's computing device (e.g., computing device **102**, as described above with reference to FIG. 1). Other structural and operational embodiments will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art(s) based on the following discussion regarding flowchart **700** and system **800** of FIG. 8.

(73) Flowchart **700** begins with step **702**. In step **702**, the decryption key is encrypted using a public encryption key associated with at least one of the user or the computing device of the user. For example, with reference to FIG. 8, encryptor **802** encrypts a decryption key **816** using a public encryption key **804**. Decryption key **816** is an example of decryption key **316**, as described above

with reference to FIG. 3. Public encryption key is retrievable from an identity map (e.g., identity map **108**, as described above with reference to FIG. 1).

(74) In step **704**, the encrypted decryption key is provided to a computing device associated with the user. For example, with reference to FIG. 8, encryptor **802** provides the encrypted decryption key (shown as encrypted decryption key **816'**) to application **818**, which executes on a computing device (e.g., computing device **102**, as described above with reference to FIG. 3). Application **818** is configured to decrypt encrypted decryption key **816'** using a private encryption key (e.g., private key **310**, as described above with reference to FIG. 3) corresponding to public encryption key **804**.

(75) FIG. 9 shows a flowchart **900** for verifying that a user is associated with an identity, according to an example embodiment. In an embodiment, flowchart **900** is implemented by a system **1000**, as shown in FIG. 10. Accordingly, flowchart **900** will be described with reference to FIG. 10. FIG. 10 depicts a block diagram of a system **1000** for verifying that a user is associated with an identity in accordance with an example embodiment. As shown in FIG. 10, system **1000** comprises identity map **108**, data retriever **304**, verifier **306**, computing device **102**, a nonce generator **1002**, and an encryptor **1010**. In accordance with an embodiment, data retriever **304**, verifier **306**, nonce generator **1002**, and encryptor **1010** are incorporated into an orchestrator (e.g., orchestrator **104**, as shown in FIG. 3) communicatively coupled to computing device **102**. Other structural and operational embodiments will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art(s) based on the following discussion regarding flowchart **900** and system **1000** of FIG. 10.

(76) Flowchart **900** begins with step **902**. In step **902**, a public encryption key associated with the user is obtained from an identity map maintained by the ledger database. For instance, with reference to FIG. 10, verifier **306** requests application **118** to prove that the user has the proper identity. In accordance with an embodiment, to prove the user's identity, verifier **306** first provides a request to application **118** for the user's identity (e.g., username, email address, etc.). Application **118** provides verifier **306** the user's identity. Responsive to receiving response **324**, verifier **306** obtains the public encryption key associated with the identity from identity map **108**. For instance, verifier **306** provides a request **1004** specifying the identity associated with the user for the user's public encryption key to identity map **108**. Identity map **108** looks up the public encryption key associated with the identity and provides the public encryption key to retriever via a response **1006**.

(77) In step **904**, a nonce is encrypted using the public encryption key. For instance, with reference to FIG. 10, nonce generator **1002** generates a nonce **1008** (e.g., a randomly-generated number) and provides nonce **1008** to encryptor **1010**. Encryptor **1010** encrypts nonce **1008** to generate an encrypted nonce **1012**. Nonce generator **1002** also provides nonce **1008** to verifier **306**.

(78) In step **906**, the encrypted nonce is provided to the computing device of the user. For example, with reference to FIG. 10, verifier **306** provides encrypted nonce **1012** to computing device via a request **1014**.

(79) In step **908**, a decrypted nonce is received from the computing device of the user. For example, with reference to FIG. 10, decryptor **308** decrypts encrypted nonce **1012** using private encryption key **310**. Computing device **102** provides the decrypted nonce to verifier **306** via a response **1016**.

(80) In step **910**, a determination is made that the decrypted nonce is the same as the nonce. For example, with reference to FIG. 10, verifier **306** compares the decrypted nonce received via response **1016** to nonce **1008** to determine whether they are the same.

(81) In step **912**, responsive to determining that the decrypted nonce is the same as the nonce, a verification is made that the user is associated with the identity. For example, with reference to FIG. 10, verifier **306** determines that the user is associated with the identity responsive to determining that the decrypted nonce is the same as the nonce.

(82) B. Key Provision Via an Untrusted Orchestrator and a Trusted Key Manager

(83) FIG. 11 depicts a block diagram of a system **1100** for obtaining a decryption key in accordance with another embodiment. As shown in FIG. 11, system **1100** includes computing device **102**, orchestrator **104**, data source **106**, identity map **108**, attribute map **110**, policy map **112**, key

manager **302**, and one or more location attribute policy (LAP) servers **1104**. LAP server(s) **1104** comprise one or more server computers or computing devices, which include one or more distributed or “cloud-based” servers, in embodiments. In embodiments, LAP server(s) **1104** are associated with, or are a part of, a cloud-based service platform and in some embodiments, LAP server(s) **1104** comprise on-premises server(s) in addition to, or in lieu of, cloud-based servers. In the embodiment described in this Subsection, orchestrator **104** is not trusted to evaluate the policy. As such, orchestrator **104** acts as an intermediary between computing device **102** and LAP server(s) **1104**. As described below, LAP server(s) **1104** require the user to prove their identity and/or attributes.

(84) As further shown in FIG. **11**, LAP server(s) **1104** comprise a proof requester **1102**, a proof verifier **1106**, and a location verifier **1132**. Computing device **102** comprises application **118**, decryptor **308**, private encryption key **310**, and one or more shared secrets **1138**. In accordance with an embodiment, each of proof requester **1102**, proof verifier **1106**, and location verifier **1132** are included in a single LAP server of LAP server(s) **1104**. In accordance with another embodiment, one or more of proof requester **1102**, proof verifier **1106**, and location verifier **1132** are included in a respective LAP server of LAP server(s) **1104**.

(85) To request a resource, application **118** provides a request **1112** identifying the resource to data source **106**. Data source **106** is configured to return a response **1114** including the encrypted resource and/or specifying at least the policy ID that identifies the policy associated with the requested resource and/or an organization that specifies and/or maintains the policy.

(86) Application **118** provides the policy ID to orchestrator **104** via a request **1116**. Orchestrator **104** provides request **1116** to a LAP server of LAP server(s) **104**. In accordance with an embodiment, application **118** also provides information that indicates a location at which computing device **102** is located via a request (e.g., request **1116**). The information includes, for example, Global Positioning System (GPS) coordinates, an Internet Protocol (IP) address, etc. In accordance with an embodiment, various organizations maintain respective LAP server(s), each configured to determine a policy for resources associated therewith. In accordance with an embodiment, the organization identified via response **1114** is a uniform resource identifier (URI) (e.g., a uniform resource locator (URL)), or an identifier utilized to lookup the URI, at which LAP server(s) of the organization and/or an identity map, attribute map, and/or policy map associated with the organization are located. In accordance with such an embodiment, request **1116** is provided to the LAP server(s) corresponding to the URI thereof.

(87) Proof requester **1102** of LAP server(s) **104** is configured to provide a request **1118** to policy map **112** associated with the organization that specifies the policy ID. Policy map **112** looks up the policy associated with policy ID and returns the policy to proof requester **1102** via a response **1120**. Proof requester **1102** analyzes the policy to determine the attribute(s) that are required to access the resource requested by application **118**. For instance, the policy specifies an identity at the organization that is allowed to access the resource, specifies that the user requires a first attribute (e.g., the user is required to have a rank level of captain), a second attribute (the user is required to have a top secret security clearance level, and/or location information that specifies that the user must be in a particular location (e.g., aboard a particular submarine) to access the resource.

(88) After determining the attribute(s), proof requester **1102** is configured to determine whether the user has the proper identity and/or attributes. For instance, proof requester **1102** requests application **118** to prove that the user has the proper identity and/or attributes. To prove the user's identity, proof requester **1102** generates a nonce (e.g., a randomly-generated number intended to prevent replay attacks) and encrypts the nonce using the public encryption key of the user, which proof requester **1102** retrieves from identity map **108** associated with the organization. Proof requester **1102** also maintains a copy of the nonce. Proof requester **1102** provides the encrypted nonce to orchestrator **104** via a request **1122**, which provides request **1122** to application **118**.

(89) Decryptor **308** is configured to decrypt the nonce using private encryption key **310** and

provides the decrypted nonce to orchestrator **104** via a response **1126**, which provides response **1126** to proof verifier **1106**. In accordance with an embodiment, decryptor **308** is a separate component (e.g., a software application, a hardware-based cryptoprocessor, etc.) from application **118** (as shown in FIG. **1**). In accordance with another embodiment, decryptor **308** is incorporated in application **118**. Private encryption key **310** is stored locally in a secure environment of computing device **102**. Examples of a secure environment include, but are not limited to, a trusted platform module (TPM), a hardware security module (HSM), or any type of secure hardware and/or software-based cryptoprocessor.

(90) Proof verifier **1106** is configured to compare the decrypted nonce to the locally-stored nonce. If the nonces match, then proof verifier **1106** determines that the user has the proper identity. Otherwise, proof verifier **1106** determines that the user does not have the proper identity and access to the encrypted resource is denied.

(91) To prove that the user has the proper attributes, proof requester **1102** requests application **118** to provide a zero-knowledge cryptographic proof that the user has the proper attributes via a request (e.g., request **1122**). In accordance with the zero-knowledge cryptographic proof, the user (or application thereof (e.g., application **118**)) proves to proof verifier **1106** that the user has the proper attributes while the user avoids conveying any additional information apart from the fact that the user has the proper attributes. In accordance with an embodiment, the request is the same request in which the encrypted nonce is provided (e.g., request **1122**). In accordance with another embodiment, the request is a different request in which the encrypted nonce is provided.

(92) The request is received by a proof generator **1124** associated with application **118**. In accordance with an embodiment, proof generator **1124** is incorporated in application **118** (as shown in FIG. **11**). In accordance with another embodiment, proof generator **1124** is a separate component (e.g., a software application, a hardware-based proof generator, etc.) from application **118**. Proof generator **1124** is configured to generate a zero-knowledge cryptographic proof based on public encryption key(s) respectively associated with the attribute(s) specified by the policy and an unencrypted version of shared secrets (shown as shared secret(s) **1138**) respectively associated with the first and second attributes. As shown in FIG. **11**, shared secret(s) **1138** are stored locally at computing device **102**. As described above, an encrypted version of shared secret(s) **1138** associated with the user and the public encryption key associated with the attributes are stored in attribute map **110**. Accordingly, proof generator **1124** retrieves the public encryption key associated with the attributes from attribute map **110**. In accordance with an embodiment, proof generator **1124** generates the cryptographic proof based on a zero-knowledge protocol, such as, but not limited to, Schnorr's protocol. Proof generator **1124** provides the cryptographic proof to orchestrator **104** via a response (e.g., response **1126**), which provides the request to proof verifier **1106** of LAP server(s) **104**.

(93) Responsive to receiving the response, proof verifier **1106** retrieves the public encryption key(s) associated with the attribute(s) specified by the policy from attribute map **110** and retrieves the encrypted secret share(s) of the user that are associated with the attribute(s) specified by the policy from attribute map **110**. Proof verifier **1106** then verifies the cryptographic proof received via the response (e.g., response **1126**) based on the public encryption key(s) associated with the attribute(s) specified by the policy and the encrypted secret share(s) retrieved from attribute map **110**. In accordance with an embodiment, proof verifier **1106** verifies the cryptographic proof based on a zero-knowledge protocol, such as, but not limited to, Schnorr's protocol. In response to determining that the cryptographic proof is valid, proof verifier **1106** provides a notification **1128** to key manager **302**. In response to determining that the cryptographic proof is not valid, proof verifier **1106** does not provide notification **1128** and access to the resource is denied.

(94) In accordance with an embodiment, location verifier **1132** compares the location information provided by application **118** to the location information specified by the policy. If the location information matches, location verifier **1132** determines that the user is at a location at which access

to the resource is allowed in accordance with the policy and provides a notification **1130** to key manager **302**. Otherwise, notification **1130** is not sent and access to the resource is denied.

(95) In accordance with an embodiment, location verifier **1132** is included in a LAP server of LAP server(s) **104** that is located at the location. For instance, if the location specified by the policy is an aircraft carrier, then location verifier **1132** is included in a LAP server that is located on the aircraft carrier. Although, it is noted that the embodiments described herein are not so limited and that any LAP server of LAP server(s) **104** designated to perform the location verification (either located locally or remotely from the specified location) performs the location verification.

(96) Key manager **302** is configured to provide the decryption key required to decrypt the resource (e.g., decryption key **316**) responsive to receiving notifications **1128** and **1130**. Key manager **302** returns the decryption key (e.g., decryption key **316**) corresponding to the resource to verifier **306** via a response **1140**.

(97) In accordance with an embodiment, LAP server(s) **1104** provide decryption key **316** to orchestrator **104**, which provides decryption key **316** to decryptor **308** (as shown in FIG. **11**). Decryptor **308** decrypts the resource for application **118**. In accordance with another embodiment, LAP server(s) **1104** encrypts decryption key **316** using the public encryption key of an entity (e.g., the user (as stored in identity map **108**), the user's device (e.g., computing device **102**), the user's application (e.g., application **118**), a document management and storage system (e.g., Microsoft SharePoint™ published by Microsoft® Corp.) that is to decrypt the resource, etc.). The public encryption key is retrieved from identity map **108**. In accordance with such an embodiment, LAP server(s) **104** sends the encrypted decryption key to the entity (e.g., application **118**). Decryptor **308** then decrypts the encrypted decryption key using the private encryption key (e.g., private key **310**) corresponding to the public encryption key. By doing so, decryption key **316** is protected from rogue users that may intercept communications between LAP server(s) **1104** and computing device **102**. In accordance with a further embodiment, LAP server(s) **1104** comprise a decryptor that decrypts the resource, and LAP server(s) **104** provide the decrypted resource to application **118**. This way, application **118** is not required to perform the decryption.

(98) Accordingly, a decryption key is obtained in many ways. For example, FIG. **12** shows a flowchart **1200** for obtaining a decryption key, according to another example embodiment. In an embodiment, flowchart **1200** is implemented by system **1100**, as shown in FIG. **11**. Accordingly, flowchart **1200** will be described with continued reference to FIG. **11**. Other structural and operational embodiments will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art(s) based on the following discussion regarding flowchart **1200** and system **1100** of FIG. **11**.

(99) Flowchart **1200** begins with step **1202**. In step **1202**, a request, from a computing device of a user, is received for decrypting a resource. The request specifies a policy identifier of a policy that specifies an attribute required to access the resource. For example, with reference to FIG. **11**, proof requester **1102** receives request **1116** from application **118** of computing device **102** via orchestrator **104** for decrypting a resource stored in data source **106**. Request **1116** specifies a policy identifier of a policy that specifies an attribute required to access the resource.

(100) In accordance with one or more embodiments, the attribute comprises at least one of a clearance level of the user, a rank of the user within an organization, or a role of the user within the organization.

(101) In step **1204**, the policy corresponding to the policy identifier is obtained from a policy map maintained by a ledger database. For example, with reference to FIG. **11**, proof requester **1102** obtains the policy corresponding to the policy identifier from policy map **112** maintained by ledger database **120** (as described above with reference to FIG. **1**). For instance, proof requester **1102** provides request **1118** specifying the policy identifier to policy map **112**. Policy map **112** looks up the policy using the policy identifier and returns the policy to proof requester **1102** via response **1120**.

(102) In step **1206**, the attribute required to access the resource is determined based on the policy.

For example, with reference to FIG. 11, proof requester **1102** analyzes the policy to determine the attribute required to access the resource.

(103) In step **1208**, a public encryption key associated with the attribute and an encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute are obtained from an attribute map maintained by the ledger database. For example, with reference to FIG. 11, proof requester **1102** obtains a public encryption key associated with the attribute and an encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute from attribute map **110** maintained by ledger database **120** (as described above with reference to FIG. 1). The public encryption key associated with the attribute and the encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute obtained from attribute map **110** are associated with the identity of the user.

(104) In step **1210**, a cryptographic proof that the user is associated with the attribute is verified based on the public encryption key associated with the attribute and the encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute. For example, with reference to FIG. 11, proof verifier **1106** verifies the cryptographic proof based on the public encryption key associated with the attribute specified by the policy and the encrypted secret share retrieved from attribute map **110**. In accordance with an embodiment, proof verifier **1106** verifies the cryptographic proof based on a zero-knowledge protocol, such as, but not limited to, Schnorr's protocol. In response to determining that the cryptographic proof is valid, proof verifier **1106** provides a notification **1128** to key manager **302**. In response to determining that the cryptographic proof is not valid, proof verifier **1106** does not provide notification **1128** and access to the resource is denied.

(105) In accordance with one or more embodiments, the cryptographic proof is based on the public encryption key associated with the attribute and an unencrypted version of the encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute.

(106) In accordance with one or more embodiments, verifying the cryptograph proof comprises providing a request for the cryptographic proof to the computing device of the user, and receiving the cryptographic proof from the computing device of the user. For example, with reference to FIG. 11, proof requester **1102** requests application **118** to provide a zero-knowledge cryptographic proof that the user has the proper attributes via a request (e.g., request **1122**). The request is received by proof generator **1124** via orchestrator **104**. Proof generator **1124** is configured to generate a zero-knowledge cryptographic proof based on public encryption key associated with the attribute specified by the policy and an unencrypted version of shared secrets (shown as shared secret(s) **1138**) respectively associated with the attribute. In accordance with an embodiment, proof generator **1124** generates the cryptographic proof based on a zero-knowledge protocol, such as, but not limited to, Schnorr's protocol. Proof generator **1124** provides the cryptographic proof to orchestrator **104** via a response (e.g., response **1126**), which provides the request to proof verifier **1106** of LAP server(s) **104**.

(107) In step **1212**, a determination is made that the user is at a location at which access to the resource is allowed in accordance with the policy. For example, with reference to FIG. 11, location verifier **1132** compares the location information provided by application **118** to the location information specified by the policy. If the location information matches, location verifier **1132** determines that the user is at a location at which access to the resource is allowed in accordance with the policy and provides a notification **1130** to key manager **302**. Otherwise, notification **1130** is not sent and access to the resource is denied.

(108) In step **1214**, responsive to determining at least that the cryptographic proof is valid and that the user is at the location, a decryption key for decrypting the resource is obtained. For example, with reference to FIG. 11, key manager **302** is configured to provide the decryption key required to decrypt the resource (e.g., decryption key **316**) responsive to receiving notifications **1128** and **1130**. Key manager **302** returns the decryption key (e.g., decryption key **316**) corresponding to the resource to verifier **306** via a response **1140**.

(109) In accordance with one or more embodiments, the resource is decrypted utilizing the decryption key, and the decrypted resource is provided to the computing device of the user. For

example, with reference to FIG. 11, LAP server(s) **1104** or key manager **302** decrypt the resource utilizing decryption key **316**, and the decrypted resource is provided to computing device **102** via orchestrator **104**. The foregoing may be performed in a similar manner as described above with reference to FIGS. 5 and 6.

(110) In accordance with one or more embodiments, the decryption key is encrypted using a public encryption key associated with the user and the encrypted decryption key is provided to the computing device of the user. For example, with reference to FIG. 11, LAP server(s) **1104** or key manager **302** encrypt decryption key **316** using a public encryption key associated with the user (e.g., retrieved from identity map **108**), and the encrypted decryption key is provided to computing device **102** via orchestrator **104**. The foregoing may be performed in a similar manner as described above with reference to FIGS. 7 and 8.

(111) In accordance with one or more embodiments, an identity of the user is verified in accordance with the policy, and responsive to determining that the cryptographic proof is valid, the user is at the location, and the identity of the user is verified, the decryption key is obtained for decrypting the resource. For example, with reference to FIG. 11, to prove the user's identity, proof requester **1102** generates a nonce (e.g., a randomly-generated number intended to prevent replay attacks) and encrypts the nonce using the public encryption key of the user, which proof requester **1102** retrieves from identity map **108** associated with the organization. Proof requester **1102** also maintains a copy of the nonce. Proof requester **1102** provides the encrypted nonce to orchestrator **104**, which provides request **1122** to application **118**. Decryptor **308** is configured to decrypt the nonce using private encryption key **310** and provides the decrypted nonce to orchestrator **104** via a response **1126**, which provides response **1126** to proof verifier **1106**. Proof verifier **1106** is configured to compare the decrypted nonce to the locally-stored nonce. If the nonces match, then proof verifier **1106** determines that the user has the proper identity. Otherwise, proof verifier **1106** determines that the user does not have the proper identity and access to the encrypted resource is denied. Decryption key **316** is obtained responsive to verifying the identity, that the identity has the attribute specified by the policy, and that the user is located at the location specified by the policy.

(112) C. Key Provision Via an Untrusted Orchestrator and an Untrusted Key Generator

(113) FIG. 13 depicts a block diagram of a system **1300** for generating a decryption key in accordance with an example embodiment. As shown in FIG. 13, system **1300** includes computing device **102**, orchestrator **104**, data source **106**, identity map **108**, attribute map **110**, policy map **112**, key manager **302**, and LAP server(s) **1304**. LAP server(s) **1304** are examples of LAP server(s) **1104**, as described above with reference to FIG. 11. As further shown in FIG. 13, LAP server(s) **1304** comprise a proof requester **1302**, a proof verifier **1306**, a key generator **1310**, and a location verifier **1332**. Proof requester **1302**, proof verifier **1306**, and location verifier **1332** are examples of proof requester **1102**, proof verifier **1106**, and location verifier **1132**, as respectively described above with reference to FIG. 11. Computing device **102** comprises application **118**, decryptor **308**, private encryption key **310**, and shared secret(s) **1338**. In accordance with an embodiment, each of proof requester **1302**, proof verifier **1306**, key generator **1310**, and location verifier **1132** are included in a single LAP server of LAP server(s) **1304**. In accordance with another embodiment, one or more of proof requester **1302**, proof verifier **1306**, key generator **1310**, and location verifier **1332** are included in a respective LAP server of LAP server(s) **104**. In the embodiment described in this Subsection, orchestrator **104** is not trusted to evaluate the policy in this embodiment. As such, orchestrator **104** acts as an intermediary between computing device **102** and LAP server(s) **1104**. In addition, proof verifier **1306** and key generator **1310** are also untrusted components.

(114) To request a resource, application **118** provides a request **1312** identifying the resource to data source **106**. Data source **106** is configured to return a response **1314** including the encrypted resource and/or specifying at least the policy ID that identifies the policy associated with the requested resource and/or an organization that specifies and/or maintains the policy.

(115) Application **118** provides the policy ID to orchestrator **104** via a request **1316**. Orchestrator

**104** provides request **1316** to a LAP server of LAP server(s) **104**. In accordance with an embodiment, application **118** also provides information that indicates a location at which computing device **102** is located via a request (e.g., request **1316**). The information includes, for example, Global Positioning System (GPS) coordinates, an Internet Protocol (IP) address, etc. In accordance with an embodiment, various organizations maintain respective LAP server(s), each configured to determine a policy for resources associated therewith. In accordance with an embodiment, the organization identified via response **1314** is a uniform resource identifier (URI) (e.g., a uniform resource locator (URL)), or an identifier utilized to lookup the URI, at which LAP server(s) of the organization and/or an identity map, attribute map, and/or policy map associated with the organization are located. In accordance with such an embodiment, request **1316** is provided to the LAP server(s) corresponding to the URI thereof.

(116) Proof requester **1302** of LAP server(s) **104** is configured to provide a request **1318** to policy map **112** associated with the organization that specifies the policy ID. Policy map **112** looks up the policy associated with policy ID and returns the policy to proof requester **1302** via a response **1320**. Proof requester **1302** analyzes the policy to determine the attribute(s) that are required to access the resource requested by application **118**. For instance, the policy specifies an identity at the organization that is allowed to access the resource, specifies that the user requires a first attribute (e.g., the user is required to have a rank level of captain), a second attribute (the user is required to have a top secret security clearance level, and/or location information that specifies that the user must be in a particular location (e.g., aboard a particular submarine) to access the resource.

(117) After determining the attribute(s), proof requester **1302** is configured to determine whether the user has the proper identity and/or attributes. For instance, proof requester **1302** requests application **118** to prove that the user has the proper identity and/or attributes. To prove the user's identity, proof requester **1302** generates a nonce (e.g., a randomly-generated number intended to prevent replay attacks) and encrypts the nonce using the public encryption key of the user, which proof requester **1302** retrieves from identity map **108** associated with the organization. Proof requester **1302** also maintains a copy of the nonce. Proof requester **1302** provides the encrypted nonce to orchestrator **104**, which provides request **1322** to application **118**.

(118) Decryptor **308** is configured to decrypt the nonce using private encryption key **310** and provides the decrypted nonce to orchestrator **104** via a response **1326**, which provides response **1326** to proof verifier **1306**.

(119) Proof verifier **1306** is configured to compare the decrypted nonce to the locally-stored nonce. If the nonces match, then proof verifier **1306** determines that the user has the proper identity. Otherwise, proof verifier **1306** determines that the user does not have the proper identity and access to the encrypted resource is denied.

(120) To prove that the user has the proper attributes, proof requester **1302** requests application **118** to provide a zero-knowledge cryptographic proof that the user has the proper attributes via a request (e.g., request **1322**). In accordance with the zero-knowledge cryptographic proof, the user (or application thereof (e.g., application **118**)) proves to proof verifier **1306** that the user has the proper attributes while the user avoids conveying any additional information apart from the fact that the user has the proper attributes. In accordance with an embodiment, the request is the same request in which the encrypted nonce is provided (e.g., request **1322**). In accordance with another embodiment, the request is a different request in which the encrypted nonce is provided.

(121) The request is received by a proof generator **1324** associated with application **118**. Proof generator **1324** is configured to generate a zero-knowledge cryptographic proof based on public encryption key(s) respectively associated with the attribute(s) specified by the policy and an unencrypted version of shared secrets (shown as shared secret(s) **1338**) respectively associated with the first and second attributes. As shown in FIG. 13, shared secret(s) **1338** are stored locally at computing device **102**. As described above, an encrypted version of shared secret(s) **1338** associated with the user and the public encryption key associated with the attributes are stored in

attribute map **110**. Accordingly, proof generator **1324** retrieves the public encryption key associated with the attributes from attribute map **110**. In accordance with an embodiment, proof generator **1324** generates the cryptographic proof based on a zero-knowledge protocol, such as, but not limited to, Schnorr's protocol. Proof generator **1324** provides the cryptographic proof to orchestrator **104** via a response (e.g., response **1326**), which provides the request to proof verifier **1306** of LAP server(s) **104**.

(122) Responsive to receiving the response, proof verifier **1306** retrieves the public encryption key(s) associated with the attribute(s) specified by the policy from attribute map **110** and retrieves the encrypted secret share(s) of the user that are associated with the attribute(s) specified by the policy from attribute map **110**. Proof verifier **1306** then verifies the cryptographic proof received via the response (e.g., response **1326**) based on the public encryption key(s) associated with the attribute(s) specified by the policy and the encrypted secret share(s) retrieved from attribute map **110**. In accordance with an embodiment, proof verifier **1306** verifies the cryptographic proof based on a zero-knowledge protocol, such as, but not limited to, Schnorr's protocol. In response to determining that the cryptographic proof is valid, proof verifier **1306** provides (or releases) a first portion **1334** of the decryption key to key generator **1310**. In accordance with an embodiment, first portion **1334** is a first set of randomly-generated numbers. In response to determining that the cryptographic proof is not valid, proof verifier **1306** does not provide the first portion of the decryption key and access to the resource is denied.

(123) In accordance with an embodiment, location verifier **1332** compares the location information provided by application **118** to the location information specified by the policy. If the location information matches, location verifier **1332** determines that the user is at a location at which access to the resource is allowed in accordance with the policy and provides (or releases) a second portion **1336** of the decryption key to key generator **1310**. In accordance with an embodiment, second portion **1336** is a second set of randomly-generated numbers.

(124) In an embodiment in which LAP server(s) **104** are located in the same location (e.g., an aircraft carrier), location verifier **1332** is configured to automatically release second portion **1336** responsive to proof verifier **1306** verifying that the cryptographic proof provided by proof generator **1324** is valid.

(125) Location verifier **1332** provides second portion **1336** to prevent collusion between multiple parties when a policy requires multiple attributes that no single party has, but multiple parties collude to provide.

(126) In accordance with an embodiment, the LAP server on which location verifier **1332** executes is configured to store second portion **1336**. For instance, when an entity encrypts the resource, the entity configures the LAP server to store second portion **1336** and specifies the condition(s) required to release second portion **1336** (e.g., the location at which the user is required to be).

(127) Key generator **1310** is configured to generate (or recover) a decryption key **1316** based on first portion **1334** and second portion **1336**. In accordance with an embodiment, key generator **1310** combines first portion **1334** with second portion **1336** to generate decryption key **1316**. For example, key generator **1310** may sum first portion **1334** with second portion **1336**. In another example, key generator **1310** may perform a polynomial evaluation with respect to first portion **1334** and second portion **1336** to generate decryption key **1316**. It is noted that any number of portions of the decryption key may be released and combined to generate decryption key **1316**. For example, a portion may be released for each proof that is verified, where a proof is received for each attribute. It is noted that key generator **1310** does not store any decryption keys, as it is an untrusted component.

(128) In accordance with an embodiment, key generator **1310** provides decryption key **1316** to decryptor **308** via orchestrator **104**, and decryptor **308** decrypts the resource for application **118**. In accordance with another embodiment, key generator **1310** encrypts decryption key **1316** using the public encryption key of an entity (e.g., the user (as stored in identity map **108**), the user's device

(e.g., computing device **102**), the user's application (e.g., application **118**), a document management and storage system (e.g., Microsoft SharePoint™ published by Microsoft® Corp.) that is to decrypt the resource, etc.). The public encryption key is retrieved from identity map **108**. In accordance with such an embodiment, key generator **1310** sends the encrypted decryption key to the entity (e.g., application **118**) via orchestrator **104**. Decryptor **308** then decrypts the encrypted decryption key using the private encryption key (e.g., private key **310**) corresponding to the public encryption key. By doing so, decryption key **1316** is protected from rogue users that may intercept communications between LAP server(s) **104** and computing device **102**. In accordance with a further embodiment, LAP server(s) **104** comprise a decryptor that decrypts the resource, and LAP server(s) **104** provide the decrypted resource to application **118**. This way, application **118** is not required to perform the decryption.

(129) It is noted that proof verifier **1306** is an untrusted component. Thus, if proof verifier **1306** falsely indicates that a cryptographic proof is valid, the decryption key generated by generator **1310** will not be computed correctly, as the user does not have the proper attributes.

(130) Accordingly, a decryption key is generated in many ways. For example, FIG. **14** shows a flowchart **1400** for generating a decryption key, according to an example embodiment. In an embodiment, flowchart **1400** is implemented by system **1300**, as shown in FIG. **13**. Accordingly, flowchart **1400** will be described with continued reference to FIG. **13**. Other structural and operational embodiments will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art(s) based on the following discussion regarding flowchart **1400** and system **1300** of FIG. **13**.

(131) Flowchart **1400** begins with step **1402**. In step **1402**, a request, from a computing device of a user, is received for decrypting a resource. The request specifies a policy identifier of a policy that specifies an attribute required to access the resource. For example, with reference to FIG. **13**, proof requester **1302** receives request **1316** from application **118** of computing device **102** via orchestrator **104** for decrypting a resource stored in data source **106**. Request **1316** specifies a policy identifier of a policy that specifies an attribute required to access the resource.

(132) In accordance with one or more embodiments, the attribute comprises at least one of a clearance level of the user, a rank of the user within an organization, or a role of the user within the organization.

(133) In step **1404**, the policy corresponding to the policy identifier is obtained from a policy map maintained by a ledger database. For example, with reference to FIG. **13**, proof requester **1302** obtains the policy corresponding to the policy identifier from policy map **112** maintained by ledger database **120** (as described above with reference to FIG. **1**). For instance, proof requester **1302** provides request **1318** specifying the policy identifier to policy map **112**. Policy map **112** looks up the policy using the policy identifier and returns the policy to proof requester **1302** via response **1320**.

(134) In step **1406**, the attribute required to access the resource is determined based on the policy. For example, with reference to FIG. **13**, proof requester **1302** analyzes the policy to determine the attribute required to access the resource.

(135) In step **1408**, a public encryption key associated with the attribute and an encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute are obtained from an attribute map maintained by the ledger database. For example, with reference to FIG. **13**, proof requester **1302** obtains a public encryption key associated with the attribute and an encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute from attribute map **110** maintained by ledger database **120** (as described above with reference to FIG. **1**). The public encryption key associated with the attribute and the encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute obtained from attribute map **110** are associated with the identity of the user.

(136) In step **1410**, a cryptographic proof that the user is associated with the attribute is verified based on the public encryption key associated with the attribute and the encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute. For example, with reference to FIG. **13**, proof verifier **1306** verifies the cryptographic proof based on the public encryption key associated with the attribute specified

by the policy and the encrypted secret share retrieved from attribute map **110**. In accordance with an embodiment, proof verifier **1306** verifies the cryptographic proof based on a zero-knowledge protocol, such as, but not limited to, Schnorr's protocol. In response to determining that the cryptographic proof is valid, proof verifier **1306** provides (or releases) a first portion **1334** of the decryption key to key generator **1310**.

(137) In accordance with one or more embodiments, the cryptographic proof is based on the public encryption key associated with the attribute and an unencrypted version of the encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute.

(138) In accordance with one or more embodiments, verifying the cryptographic proof comprises providing a request for the cryptographic proof to the computing device of the user, and receiving the cryptographic proof from the computing device of the user. For example, with reference to FIG. **13**, proof requester **1302** requests application **118** to provide a zero-knowledge cryptographic proof that the user has the proper attributes via a request (e.g., request **1322**). The request is received by a proof generator **1324** associated with application **118**. Proof generator **1324** is configured to generate a zero-knowledge cryptographic proof based on public encryption key associated with the attribute specified by the policy and an unencrypted version of shared secrets (shown as shared secret(s) **1338**) respectively associated with the attribute. In accordance with an embodiment, proof generator **1324** generates the cryptographic proof based on a zero-knowledge protocol, such as, but not limited to, Schnorr's protocol. Proof generator **1324** provides the cryptographic proof to orchestrator **104** via a response (e.g., response **1326**), which provides the request to proof verifier **1106** of LAP server(s) **104**.

(139) In step **1412**, a determination is made that the user is at a location at which access to the resource is allowed in accordance with the policy. For example, with reference to FIG. **13**, location verifier **1332** compares the location information provided by application **118** to the location information specified by the policy. If the location information matches, location verifier **1332** provides (or releases) second portion **1336** of the decryption key to key generator **1310**.

(140) In step **1414**, responsive to determining at least that the cryptographic proof is valid and that the user is at the location, a decryption key for decrypting the resource is generated. For example, with reference to FIG. **13**, key generator **1310** is configured to generate (or recover) decryption key **1316** based on first portion **1334** and second portion **1336**.

(141) In accordance with an embodiment, key generator **1310** combines first portion **1334** with second portion **1336** to generate decryption key **1316**. For example, key generator **1310** may sum first portion **1334** with second portion **1336**. In another example, key generator **1310** may perform a polynomial evaluation with respect to first portion **1334** and second portion **1336** to generate decryption key **1316**.

(142) In accordance with one or more embodiments, the resource is decrypted utilizing the decryption key, and the decrypted resource is provided to the computing device of the user. For example, with reference to FIG. **13**, LAP server(s) **1304** decrypt the resource utilizing decryption key **1316**, and the decrypted resource is provided to computing device **102** via orchestrator **104**. The foregoing may be performed in a similar manner as described above with reference to FIGS. **5** and **6**.

(143) In accordance with one or more embodiments, the decryption key is encrypted using a public encryption key associated with the user and the encrypted decryption key is provided to the computing device of the user. For example, with reference to FIG. **13**, LAP server(s) **1304** encrypt decryption key **1316** using a public encryption key associated with the user (e.g., retrieved from identity map **108**), and the encrypted decryption key is provided to computing device **102** via orchestrator **104**. The foregoing may be performed in a similar manner as described above with reference to FIGS. **7** and **8**.

(144) In accordance with one or more embodiments, an identity of the user is verified in accordance with the policy, and responsive to determining that the cryptographic proof is valid, the

user is at the location, and the identity of the user is verified, the decryption key is generated for decrypting the resource. For example, with reference to FIG. 13, to prove the user's identity, proof requester **1302** generates a nonce (e.g., a randomly-generated number intended to prevent replay attacks) and encrypts the nonce using the public encryption key of the user, which proof requester **1302** retrieves from identity map **108** associated with the organization. Proof requester **1302** also maintains a copy of the nonce. Proof requester **1302** provides the encrypted nonce to orchestrator **104**, which provides request **1322** to application **118**. Decryptor **308** is configured to decrypt the nonce using private encryption key **310** and provides the decrypted nonce to orchestrator **104** via a response **1326**, which provides response **1326** to proof verifier **1306**. Proof verifier **1306** is configured to compare the decrypted nonce to the locally-stored nonce. If the nonces match, then proof verifier **1306** determines that the user has the proper identity. Otherwise, proof verifier **1306** determines that the user does not have the proper identity and access to the encrypted resource is denied. Decryption key **1316** is generated responsive to verifying the identity, that the identity has the attribute specified by the policy, and that the user is located at the location specified by the policy.

### III. Example Mobile Device and Computer System Implementation

(145) Each of computing device **102**, orchestrator **104**, data source **106**, identity map **108**, attribute map **110**, policy map **112**, DB host(s) **116**, application **118**, ledger database **120**, ledger database **200**, ledger **206**, blocks **208-214**, key manager **302**, data retriever **304**, verifier **306**, decryptor **308**, decryptor **606**, application **618**, encryptor **802**, application **818**, nonce generator **1002**, encryptor **1010**, LAP server(s) **1104**, proof requester **1102**, proof verifier **1106**, location verifier **1132**, proof generator **1124**, LAP server(s) **1304**, proof requester **1302**, proof verifier **1306**, key generator **1310**, location verifier **1332**, and/or proof generator **1324** and/or each of the steps of flowcharts **400**, **500**, **700**, **900**, **1200**, and/or **1400** may be implemented in hardware, or hardware combined with software and/or firmware. For example, computing device **102**, orchestrator **104**, data source **106**, identity map **108**, attribute map **110**, policy map **112**, DB host(s) **116**, application **118**, ledger database **120**, ledger database **200**, ledger **206**, blocks **208-214**, key manager **302**, data retriever **304**, verifier **306**, decryptor **308**, decryptor **606**, application **618**, encryptor **802**, application **818**, nonce generator **1002**, encryptor **1010**, LAP server(s) **1104**, proof requester **1102**, proof verifier **1106**, location verifier **1132**, proof generator **1124**, LAP server(s) **1304**, proof requester **1302**, proof verifier **1306**, key generator **1310**, location verifier **1332**, and/or proof generator **1324** (and/or any of the components thereof) and/or the steps of flowcharts **400**, **500**, **700**, **900**, **1200**, and/or **1400** may be implemented as computer program code (e.g., instructions in a programming language) configured to be executed in one or more processors and stored in a computer readable storage medium. Alternatively, computing device **102**, orchestrator **104**, data source **106**, identity map **108**, attribute map **110**, policy map **112**, DB host(s) **116**, application **118**, ledger database **120**, ledger database **200**, ledger **206**, blocks **208-214**, key manager **302**, data retriever **304**, verifier **306**, decryptor **308**, decryptor **606**, application **618**, encryptor **802**, application **818**, nonce generator **1002**, encryptor **1010**, LAP server(s) **1104**, proof requester **1102**, proof verifier **1106**, location verifier **1132**, proof generator **1124**, LAP server(s) **1304**, proof requester **1302**, proof verifier **1306**, key generator **1310**, location verifier **1332**, and/or proof generator **1324** (and/or any of the components thereof) and/or the steps of flowcharts **400**, **500**, **700**, **900**, **1200**, and/or **1400** may be implemented as hardware logic/electrical circuitry, such as being implemented together in a system-on-chip (SoC), a field programmable gate array (FPGA), or an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC). A SoC may include an integrated circuit chip that includes one or more of a processor (e.g., a microcontroller, microprocessor, digital signal processor (DSP), etc.), memory, one or more communication interfaces, and/or further circuits and/or embedded firmware to perform its functions.

(146) Embodiments disclosed herein may be implemented in one or more computing devices that may be mobile (a mobile device) and/or stationary (a stationary device) and may include any

combination of the features of such mobile and stationary computing devices. Examples of computing devices in which embodiments may be implemented are described as follows with respect to FIG. 15. FIG. 15 shows a block diagram of an exemplary computing environment 1500 that includes a computing device 1502. In some embodiments, computing device 1502 is communicatively coupled with devices (not shown in FIG. 15) external to computing environment 1500 via network 1504. Network 1504 comprises one or more networks such as local area networks (LANs), wide area networks (WANs), enterprise networks, the Internet, etc., and may include one or more wired and/or wireless portions. Network 1504 may additionally or alternatively include a cellular network for cellular communications. Computing device 1502 is described in detail as follows

(147) Computing device 1502 can be any of a variety of types of computing devices. For example, computing device 1502 may be a mobile computing device such as a handheld computer (e.g., a personal digital assistant (PDA)), a laptop computer, a tablet computer (such as an Apple iPad™), a hybrid device, a notebook computer (e.g., a Google Chromebook™ by Google LLC), a netbook, a mobile phone (e.g., a cell phone, a smart phone such as an Apple® iPhone® by Apple Inc., a phone implementing the Google® Android™ operating system, etc.), a wearable computing device (e.g., a head-mounted augmented reality and/or virtual reality device including smart glasses such as Google® Glass™, Oculus Rift® of Facebook Technologies, LLC, etc.), or other type of mobile computing device. Computing device 1502 may alternatively be a stationary computing device such as a desktop computer, a personal computer (PC), a stationary server device, a minicomputer, a mainframe, a supercomputer, etc.

(148) As shown in FIG. 15, computing device 1502 includes a variety of hardware and software components, including a processor 1510, a storage 1520, one or more input devices 1530, one or more output devices 1550, one or more wireless modems 1560, one or more wired interface(s) 1580, a power supply 1582, a location information (LI) receiver 1584, and an accelerometer 1586. Storage 1520 includes memory 1556, which includes non-removable memory 1522 and removable memory 1524, and a storage device 1590. Storage 1520 also stores an operating system 1512, application programs 1514, and application data 1516. Wireless modem(s) 1560 include a Wi-Fi modem 1562, a Bluetooth modem 1564, and a cellular modem 1566. Output device(s) 1550 includes a speaker 1552 and a display 1554. Input device(s) 1530 includes a touch screen 1532, a microphone 1534, a camera 1536, a physical keyboard 1538, and a trackball 1540. Not all components of computing device 1502 shown in FIG. 15 are present in all embodiments, additional components not shown may be present, and any combination of the components may be present in a particular embodiment. These components of computing device 1502 are described as follows.

(149) A single processor 1510 (e.g., central processing unit (CPU), microcontroller, a microprocessor, signal processor, ASIC (application specific integrated circuit), and/or other physical hardware processor circuit) or multiple processors 1510 may be present in computing device 1502 for performing such tasks as program execution, signal coding, data processing, input/output processing, power control, and/or other functions. Processor 1510 may be a single-core or multi-core processor, and each processor core may be single-threaded or multithreaded (to provide multiple threads of execution concurrently). Processor 1510 is configured to execute program code stored in a computer readable medium, such as program code of operating system 1512 and application programs 1514 stored in storage 1520. Operating system 1512 controls the allocation and usage of the components of computing device 1502 and provides support for one or more application programs 1514 (also referred to as “applications” or “apps”). Application programs 1514 may include common computing applications (e.g., e-mail applications, calendars, contact managers, web browsers, messaging applications), further computing applications (e.g., word processing applications, mapping applications, media player applications, productivity suite applications), one or more machine learning (ML) models, as well as applications related to the embodiments disclosed elsewhere herein.

(150) Any component in computing device **1502** can communicate with any other component according to function, although not all connections are shown for ease of illustration. For instance, as shown in FIG. 15, bus **1506** is a multiple signal line communication medium (e.g., conductive traces in silicon, metal traces along a motherboard, wires, etc.) that may be present to communicatively couple processor **1510** to various other components of computing device **1502**, although in other embodiments, an alternative bus, further buses, and/or one or more individual signal lines may be present to communicatively couple components. Bus **1506** represents one or more of any of several types of bus structures, including a memory bus or memory controller, a peripheral bus, an accelerated graphics port, and a processor or local bus using any of a variety of bus architectures.

(151) Storage **1520** is physical storage that includes one or both of memory **1556** and storage device **1590**, which store operating system **1512**, application programs **1514**, and application data **1516** according to any distribution. Non-removable memory **1522** includes one or more of RAM (random access memory), ROM (read only memory), flash memory, a solid-state drive (SSD), a hard disk drive (e.g., a disk drive for reading from and writing to a hard disk), and/or other physical memory device type. Non-removable memory **1522** may include main memory and may be separate from or fabricated in a same integrated circuit as processor **1510**. As shown in FIG. 15, non-removable memory **1522** stores firmware **1518**, which may be present to provide low-level control of hardware. Examples of firmware **1518** include BIOS (Basic Input/Output System, such as on personal computers) and boot firmware (e.g., on smart phones). Removable memory **1524** may be inserted into a receptacle of or otherwise coupled to computing device **1502** and can be removed by a user from computing device **1502**. Removable memory **1524** can include any suitable removable memory device type, including an SD (Secure Digital) card, a Subscriber Identity Module (SIM) card, which is well known in GSM (Global System for Mobile Communications) communication systems, and/or other removable physical memory device type. One or more of storage device **1590** may be present that are internal and/or external to a housing of computing device **1502** and may or may not be removable. Examples of storage device **1590** include a hard disk drive, a SSD, a thumb drive (e.g., a USB (Universal Serial Bus) flash drive), or other physical storage device.

(152) One or more programs may be stored in storage **1520**. Such programs include operating system **1512**, one or more application programs **1514**, and other program modules and program data. Examples of such application programs may include, for example, computer program logic (e.g., computer program code/instructions) for implementing one or more of, orchestrator **104**, DB host(s) **116**, application **118**, ledger database **120**, ledger database **200**, ledger **206**, blocks **208-214**, key manager **302**, data retriever **304**, verifier **306**, decryptor **308**, decryptor **606**, application **618**, encryptor **802**, application **818**, nonce generator **1002**, encryptor **1010**, LAP server(s) **1104**, proof requester **1102**, proof verifier **1106**, location verifier **1132**, proof generator **1124**, LAP server(s) **1304**, proof requester **1302**, proof verifier **1306**, key generator **1310**, location verifier **1332**, and/or proof generator **1324**, along with any components and/or subcomponents thereof, as well as the flowcharts/flow diagrams (e.g., flowcharts **400**, **500**, **700**, **900**, **1200**, and/or **1400**) described herein, including portions thereof, and/or further examples described herein.

(153) Storage **1520** also stores data used and/or generated by operating system **1512** and application programs **1514** as application data **1516**. Examples of application data **1516** include web pages, text, images, tables, sound files, video data, and other data, which may also be sent to and/or received from one or more network servers or other devices via one or more wired or wireless networks. Storage **1520** can be used to store further data including a subscriber identifier, such as an International Mobile Subscriber Identity (IMSI), and an equipment identifier, such as an International Mobile Equipment Identifier (IMEI). Such identifiers can be transmitted to a network server to identify users and equipment.

(154) A user may enter commands and information into computing device **1502** through one or

more input devices **1530** and may receive information from computing device **1502** through one or more output devices **1550**. Input device(s) **1530** may include one or more of touch screen **1532**, microphone **1534**, camera **1536**, physical keyboard **1538** and/or trackball **1540** and output device(s) **1550** may include one or more of speaker **1552** and display **1554**. Each of input device(s) **1530** and output device(s) **1550** may be integral to computing device **1502** (e.g., built into a housing of computing device **1502**) or external to computing device **1502** (e.g., communicatively coupled wired or wirelessly to computing device **1502** via wired interface(s) **1580** and/or wireless modem(s) **1560**). Further input devices **1530** (not shown) can include a Natural User Interface (NUI), a pointing device (computer mouse), a joystick, a video game controller, a scanner, a touch pad, a stylus pen, a voice recognition system to receive voice input, a gesture recognition system to receive gesture input, or the like. Other possible output devices (not shown) can include piezoelectric or other haptic output devices. Some devices can serve more than one input/output function. For instance, display **1554** may display information, as well as operating as touch screen **1532** by receiving user commands and/or other information (e.g., by touch, finger gestures, virtual keyboard, etc.) as a user interface. Any number of each type of input device(s) **1530** and output device(s) **1550** may be present, including multiple microphones **1534**, multiple cameras **1536**, multiple speakers **1552**, and/or multiple displays **1554**.

(155) One or more wireless modems **1560** can be coupled to antenna(s) (not shown) of computing device **1502** and can support two-way communications between processor **1510** and devices external to computing device **1502** through network **1504**, as would be understood to persons skilled in the relevant art(s). Wireless modem **1560** is shown generically and can include a cellular modem **1566** for communicating with one or more cellular networks, such as a GSM network for data and voice communications within a single cellular network, between cellular networks, or between the mobile device and a public switched telephone network (PSTN). Wireless modem **1560** may also or alternatively include other radio-based modem types, such as a Bluetooth modem **1564** (also referred to as a “Bluetooth device”) and/or Wi-Fi **1562** modem (also referred to as an “wireless adaptor”). Wi-Fi modem **1562** is configured to communicate with an access point or other remote Wi-Fi-capable device according to one or more of the wireless network protocols based on the IEEE (Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers) 802.11 family of standards, commonly used for local area networking of devices and Internet access. Bluetooth modem **1564** is configured to communicate with another Bluetooth-capable device according to the Bluetooth short-range wireless technology standard(s) such as IEEE 802.15.1 and/or managed by the Bluetooth Special Interest Group (SIG).

(156) Computing device **1502** can further include power supply **1582**, LI receiver **1584**, accelerometer **1586**, and/or one or more wired interfaces **1580**. Example wired interfaces **1580** include a USB port, IEEE 1394 (FireWire) port, a RS-232 port, an HDMI (High-Definition Multimedia Interface) port (e.g., for connection to an external display), a DisplayPort port (e.g., for connection to an external display), an audio port, an Ethernet port, and/or an Apple® Lightning® port, the purposes and functions of each of which are well known to persons skilled in the relevant art(s). Wired interface(s) **1580** of computing device **1502** provide for wired connections between computing device **1502** and network **1504**, or between computing device **1502** and one or more devices/peripherals when such devices/peripherals are external to computing device **1502** (e.g., a pointing device, display **1554**, speaker **1552**, camera **1536**, physical keyboard **1538**, etc.). Power supply **1582** is configured to supply power to each of the components of computing device **1502** and may receive power from a battery internal to computing device **1502**, and/or from a power cord plugged into a power port of computing device **1502** (e.g., a USB port, an A/C power port). LI receiver **1584** may be used for location determination of computing device **1502** and may include a satellite navigation receiver such as a Global Positioning System (GPS) receiver or may include other type of location determiner configured to determine location of computing device **1502** based on received information (e.g., using cell tower triangulation, etc.). Accelerometer **1586** may be

present to determine an orientation of computing device **1502**.

(157) Note that the illustrated components of computing device **1502** are not required or all-inclusive, and fewer or greater numbers of components may be present as would be recognized by one skilled in the art. For example, computing device **1502** may also include one or more of a gyroscope, barometer, proximity sensor, ambient light sensor, digital compass, etc. Processor **1510** and memory **1556** may be co-located in a same semiconductor device package, such as being included together in an integrated circuit chip, FPGA, or system-on-chip (SOC), optionally along with further components of computing device **1502**.

(158) In embodiments, computing device **1502** is configured to implement any of the above-described features of flowcharts herein. Computer program logic for performing any of the operations, steps, and/or functions described herein may be stored in storage **1520** and executed by processor **1510**.

(159) In some embodiments, server infrastructure **1570** may be present in computing environment **1500** and may be communicatively coupled with computing device **1502** via network **1504**. Server infrastructure **1570**, when present, may be a network-accessible server set (e.g., a cloud-based environment or platform). As shown in FIG. 15, server infrastructure **1570** includes clusters **1572**. Each of clusters **1572** may comprise a group of one or more compute nodes and/or a group of one or more storage nodes. For example, as shown in FIG. 15, cluster **1572** includes nodes **1574**. Each of nodes **1574** are accessible via network **1504** (e.g., in a “cloud-based” embodiment) to build, deploy, and manage applications and services. Any of nodes **1574** may be a storage node that comprises a plurality of physical storage disks, SSDs, and/or other physical storage devices that are accessible via network **1504** and are configured to store data associated with the applications and services managed by nodes **1574**. For example, as shown in FIG. 15, nodes **1574** may store application data **1578**.

(160) Each of nodes **1574** may, as a compute node, comprise one or more server computers, server systems, and/or computing devices. For instance, a node **1574** may include one or more of the components of computing device **1502** disclosed herein. Each of nodes **1574** may be configured to execute one or more software applications (or “applications”) and/or services and/or manage hardware resources (e.g., processors, memory, etc.), which may be utilized by users (e.g., customers) of the network-accessible server set. For example, as shown in FIG. 15, nodes **1574** may operate application programs **1576**. In an implementation, a node of nodes **1574** may operate or comprise one or more virtual machines, with each virtual machine emulating a system architecture (e.g., an operating system), in an isolated manner, upon which applications such as application programs **1576** may be executed.

(161) In an embodiment, one or more of clusters **1572** may be co-located (e.g., housed in one or more nearby buildings with associated components such as backup power supplies, redundant data communications, environmental controls, etc.) to form a datacenter, or may be arranged in other manners. Accordingly, in an embodiment, one or more of clusters **1572** may be a datacenter in a distributed collection of datacenters. In embodiments, exemplary computing environment **1500** comprises part of a cloud-based platform such as Amazon Web Services® of Amazon Web Services, Inc. or Google Cloud Platform™ of Google LLC, although these are only examples and are not intended to be limiting.

(162) In an embodiment, computing device **1502** may access application programs **1576** for execution in any manner, such as by a client application and/or a browser at computing device **1502**. Example browsers include Microsoft Edge® by Microsoft Corp. of Redmond, Washington, Mozilla Firefox®, by Mozilla Corp. of Mountain View, California, Safari®, by Apple Inc. of Cupertino, California, and Google® Chrome by Google LLC of Mountain View, California.

(163) For purposes of network (e.g., cloud) backup and data security, computing device **1502** may additionally and/or alternatively synchronize copies of application programs **1514** and/or application data **1516** to be stored at network-based server infrastructure **1570** as application

programs **1576** and/or application data **1578**. For instance, operating system **1512** and/or application programs **1514** may include a file hosting service client, such as Microsoft® OneDrive® by Microsoft Corporation, Amazon Simple Storage Service (Amazon **53**)® by Amazon Web Services, Inc., Dropbox® by Dropbox, Inc., Google Drive™ by Google LLC, etc., configured to synchronize applications and/or data stored in storage **1520** at network-based server infrastructure **1570**.

(164) In some embodiments, on-premises servers **1592** may be present in computing environment **1500** and may be communicatively coupled with computing device **1502** via network **1504**. On-premises servers **1592**, when present, are hosted within an organization's infrastructure and, in many cases, physically onsite of a facility of that organization. On-premises servers **1592** are controlled, administered, and maintained by IT (Information Technology) personnel of the organization or an IT partner to the organization. Application data **1598** may be shared by on-premises servers **1592** between computing devices of the organization, including computing device **1502** (when part of an organization) through a local network of the organization, and/or through further networks accessible to the organization (including the Internet). Furthermore, on-premises servers **1592** may serve applications such as application programs **1596** to the computing devices of the organization, including computing device **1502**. Accordingly, on-premises servers **1592** may include storage **1594** (which includes one or more physical storage devices such as storage disks and/or SSDs) for storage of application programs **1596** and application data **1598** and may include one or more processors for execution of application programs **1596**. Still further, computing device **1502** may be configured to synchronize copies of application programs **1514** and/or application data **1516** for backup storage at on-premises servers **1592** as application programs **1596** and/or application data **1598**.

(165) Embodiments described herein may be implemented in one or more of computing device **1502**, network-based server infrastructure **1570**, and on-premises servers **1592**. For example, in some embodiments, computing device **1502** may be used to implement systems, clients, or devices, or components/subcomponents thereof, disclosed elsewhere herein. In other embodiments, a combination of computing device **1502**, network-based server infrastructure **1570**, and/or on-premises servers **1592** may be used to implement the systems, clients, or devices, or components/subcomponents thereof, disclosed elsewhere herein.

(166) As used herein, the terms “computer program medium,” “computer-readable medium,” and “computer-readable storage medium,” etc., are used to refer to physical hardware media. Examples of such physical hardware media include any hard disk, optical disk, SSD, other physical hardware media such as RAMs, ROMs, flash memory, digital video disks, zip disks, MEMs (microelectronic machine) memory, nanotechnology-based storage devices, and further types of physical/tangible hardware storage media of storage **1520**. Such computer-readable media and/or storage media are distinguished from and non-overlapping with communication media and propagating signals (do not include communication media and propagating signals). Communication media embodies computer-readable instructions, data structures, program modules or other data in a modulated data signal such as a carrier wave. The term “modulated data signal” means a signal that has one or more of its characteristics set or changed in such a manner as to encode information in the signal. By way of example, and not limitation, communication media includes wireless media such as acoustic, RF, infrared and other wireless media, as well as wired media. Embodiments are also directed to such communication media that are separate and non-overlapping with embodiments directed to computer-readable storage media.

(167) As noted above, computer programs and modules (including application programs **1514**) may be stored in storage **1520**. Such computer programs may also be received via wired interface(s) **1580** and/or wireless modem(s) **1560** over network **1504**. Such computer programs, when executed or loaded by an application, enable computing device **1502** to implement features of embodiments discussed herein. Accordingly, such computer programs represent controllers of the computing

device **1502**.

(168) Embodiments are also directed to computer program products comprising computer code or instructions stored on any computer-readable medium or computer-readable storage medium. Such computer program products include the physical storage of storage **1520** as well as further physical storage types.

#### IV. Additional Example Embodiments

(169) A system is described herein. The system includes at least one processor; and at least one memory that stores program code that, when executed by the at least one processor, performs operations. The operations comprise: receiving, from a computing device of a user, a request for decrypting a resource, the request specifying a policy identifier of a policy that specifies an attribute required to access the resource; obtaining the policy corresponding to the policy identifier from a policy map maintained by a ledger database; determining the attribute required to access the resource based on the policy; obtaining, from an attribute map maintained by the ledger database, a public encryption key associated with the attribute and an encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute; verifying a cryptographic proof that the user is associated with the attribute based on the public encryption key associated with the attribute and the encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute; determining that the user is at a location at which access to the resource is allowed in accordance with the policy; and responsive to determining at least that the cryptographic proof is valid and that the user is at the location, generating a decryption key for decrypting the resource.

(170) In one implementation of the foregoing system, verifying the cryptographic proof comprises: providing a request for the cryptographic proof to the computing device of the user; and receiving the cryptographic proof from the computing device of the user.

(171) In one implementation of the foregoing system, the attribute comprises at least one of: a clearance level of the user; a rank of the user within an organization; or a role of the user within the organization.

(172) In one implementation of the foregoing system, the operations further comprise: encrypting the decryption key using a public encryption key associated with at least one of the user or the computing device of the user; and providing the encrypted decryption key to the computing device of the user.

(173) In one implementation of the foregoing system, the operations further comprise: decrypting the resource utilizing the decryption key, and providing the decrypted resource to the computing device of the user.

(174) In one implementation of the foregoing system, the operations further comprise: verifying an identity of the user in accordance with the policy; and responsive to determining that the cryptographic proof is valid, the user is at the location, and the identity of the user is verified, generating the decryption key for decrypting the resource.

(175) In one implementation of the foregoing system, the cryptographic proof is based on the public encryption key associated with the attribute and an unencrypted version of the encrypted.

(176) A method is also disclosed herein. The method includes: receiving, from a computing device of a user, a request for decrypting a resource, the request specifying a policy identifier of a policy that specifies an attribute required to access the resource; obtaining the policy corresponding to the policy identifier from a policy map maintained by a ledger database; determining the attribute required to access the resource based on the policy; obtaining, from an attribute map maintained by the ledger database, a public encryption key associated with the attribute and an encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute; verifying a cryptographic proof that the user is associated with the attribute based on the public encryption key associated with the attribute and the encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute; determining that the user is at a location at which access to the resource is allowed in accordance with the policy; and responsive to determining at least that the cryptographic proof is valid and that the user is at the location, obtaining a decryption key for

decrypting the resource.

(177) In one implementation of the foregoing method, verifying the cryptographic proof comprises: providing a request for the cryptographic proof to the computing device of the user; and receiving the cryptographic proof from the computing device of the user.

(178) In one implementation of the foregoing method, the attribute comprises at least one of: a clearance level of the user; a rank of the user within an organization; or a role of the user within the organization.

(179) In one implementation of the foregoing method, the method further comprises: encrypting the decryption key using a public encryption key associated with at least one of the user or the computing device of the user; and providing the encrypted decryption key to a computing device associated with the user.

(180) In one implementation of the foregoing method, the method further comprises: decrypting the resource utilizing the decryption key; and providing the decrypted resource to the computing device of the user.

(181) In one implementation of the foregoing method, the method further comprises: verifying an identity of the user in accordance with the policy; and responsive to determining that the cryptographic proof is valid, the user is at the location, and the identity of the user is verified, obtaining the decryption key for decrypting the resource.

(182) In one implementation of the foregoing method, the cryptographic proof is based on the public encryption key associated with the attribute and an unencrypted version of the encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute.

(183) A computer-readable storage medium having program instructions recorded thereon that, when executed by at least one processor, perform a method. The method includes: receiving, from a computing device of a user, a request for decrypting a resource, the request specifying a policy identifier of a policy that specifies an identity authorized to access the resource and a first attribute required to access the resource; obtaining the policy corresponding to the policy identifier from a policy map maintained by a ledger database; determining the identity authorized to access the resource and the first attribute required to access the resource based on the policy; verifying that the user is associated with the identity; responsive to verifying that the user is associated with the identity, obtaining a second attribute of the user from an attribute map maintained by the ledger database; determining that the second attribute is the same as the first attribute; and responsive to determining that second attribute is the same as the first attribute, obtaining a decryption key for decrypting the resource.

(184) In one implementation of the foregoing computer-readable storage medium, verifying the second identity comprises: obtaining a public encryption key associated with the user from an identity map maintained by the ledger database; encrypting a nonce using the public encryption key; providing the encrypted nonce to the computing device of the user; receiving a decrypted nonce from the computing device of the user; determining that the decrypted nonce is the same as the nonce; and responsive to determining that the decrypted nonce is the same as the nonce, verifying that the user is associated with the identity.

(185) In one implementation of the foregoing computer-readable storage medium, the first attribute comprises at least one of: a clearance level of the user; a rank of the user within an organization; or a role of the user within the organization.

(186) In one implementation of the foregoing computer-readable storage medium, the method further comprises: encrypting the decryption key using a public encryption key associated with at least one of the user or the computing device of the user; and providing the encrypted decryption key to the computing device of the user.

(187) In one implementation of the foregoing computer-readable storage medium, the method further comprises: decrypting the resource utilizing the decryption key; and providing the decrypted resource to the computing device of the user.

(188) In one implementation of the foregoing computer-readable storage medium, the resource comprises at least one of: a data file; a database object; structured data; unstructured data; or a data container.

## V. Conclusion

(189) References in the specification to “one embodiment,” “an embodiment,” “an example embodiment,” etc., indicate that the embodiment described may include a particular feature, structure, or characteristic, but every embodiment may not necessarily include the particular feature, structure, or characteristic. Moreover, such phrases are not necessarily referring to the same embodiment. Further, when a particular feature, structure, or characteristic is described in connection with an embodiment, it is submitted that it is within the knowledge of one skilled in the art to effect such feature, structure, or characteristic in connection with other embodiments whether or not explicitly described.

(190) In the discussion, unless otherwise stated, adjectives such as “substantially” and “about” modifying a condition or relationship characteristic of a feature or features of an embodiment of the disclosure, are understood to mean that the condition or characteristic is defined to within tolerances that are acceptable for operation of the embodiment for an application for which it is intended. Furthermore, where “based on” is used to indicate an effect being a result of an indicated cause, it is to be understood that the effect is not required to only result from the indicated cause, but that any number of possible additional causes may also contribute to the effect. Thus, as used herein, the term “based on” should be understood to be equivalent to the term “based at least on.”

(191) While various embodiments of the present disclosure have been described above, it should be understood that they have been presented by way of example only, and not limitation. It will be understood by those skilled in the relevant art(s) that various changes in form and details may be made therein without departing from the spirit and scope of the invention as defined in the appended claims. Accordingly, the breadth and scope of the present invention should not be limited by any of the above-described exemplary embodiments, but should be defined only in accordance with the following claims and their equivalents.

## Claims

1. A system, comprising: a processor; and a memory that stores program code that, when executed by the processor, performs operations, the operations comprising: receiving, from a computing device of a user, a request for decrypting a resource, the request specifying a policy identifier of a policy that specifies an attribute required to access the resource; obtaining the policy corresponding to the policy identifier from a policy map; determining the attribute required to access the resource based on the policy; obtaining, from an attribute map, a public encryption key associated with the attribute and an encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute; providing, to the computing device of the user, a request for a cryptographic proof; receiving the cryptographic proof from the computing device of the user, the cryptographic proof generated based on the public encryption key associated with the attribute and an unencrypted version of the shared secret stored on the computing device of the user; verifying the cryptographic proof that the user is associated with the attribute based on the public encryption key associated with the attribute and the encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute; and responsive to determining that the cryptographic proof is valid, generating a decryption key for decrypting the resource.

2. The system of claim 1, wherein the attribute comprises at least one of: a clearance level of the user; a rank of the user within an organization; or a role of the user within the organization.

3. The system of claim 1, the operations further comprising: encrypting the decryption key using a public encryption key associated with at least one of the user or the computing device of the user; and providing the encrypted decryption key to the computing device of the user.

4. The system of claim 1, the operations further comprising: decrypting the resource utilizing the

decryption key; and providing the decrypted resource to the computing device of the user.

5. The system of claim 1, the operations further comprising: determining that the user is at a location at which access to the resource is allowed in accordance with the policy; verifying an identity of the user in accordance with the policy; and responsive to determining that the cryptographic proof is valid, the user is at the location, and the identity of the user is verified, generating the decryption key for decrypting the resource.

6. The system of claim 1, wherein the cryptographic proof comprises: a zero-knowledge proof.

7. The system of claim 1, wherein the operations further comprise: providing, to the computing device of the user, a second request for a second cryptographic proof; receiving the second cryptographic proof from the computing device of the user, the cryptographic proof generated based on the public encryption key associated with a second attribute and an unencrypted version of a second shared secret stored on the computing device of the user; and verifying the second cryptographic proof that the user is associated with the second attribute based on the public encryption key associated with the second attribute and a second encrypted shared secret associated with the second attribute, wherein generating the decryption key is further responsive to verifying the second cryptographic proof.

8. A method, comprising: receiving, from a computing device of a user, a request for decrypting a resource, the request specifying a policy identifier of a policy that specifies an attribute required to access the resource; obtaining the policy corresponding to the policy identifier from a policy map; determining the attribute required to access the resource based on the policy; obtaining, from an attribute map, a public encryption key associated with the attribute and an encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute; providing, to the computing device of the user, a request for a cryptographic proof; and receiving the cryptographic proof from the computing device of the user, the cryptographic proof generated based on the public encryption key associated with the attribute and an unencrypted version of the shared secret stored on the computing device of the user; verifying the cryptographic proof that the user is associated with the attribute based on the public encryption key associated with the attribute and the encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute; and responsive to determining that the cryptographic proof is valid, obtaining a decryption key for decrypting the resource.

9. The method of claim 8, wherein the attribute comprises at least one of: a clearance level of the user; a rank of the user within an organization; or a role of the user within the organization.

10. The method of claim 8, further comprising: encrypting the decryption key using a public encryption key associated with at least one of the user or the computing device of the user; and providing the encrypted decryption key to the computing device of the user.

11. The method of claim 8, further comprising: decrypting the resource utilizing the decryption key; and providing the decrypted resource to the computing device of the user.

12. The method of claim 8, further comprising: determining that the user is at a location at which access to the resource is allowed in accordance with the policy; verifying an identity of the user in accordance with the policy; and responsive to determining that the cryptographic proof is valid, the user is at the location, and the identity of the user is verified, obtaining the decryption key for decrypting the resource.

13. The method of claim 8, wherein the cryptographic proof comprises: a zero-knowledge proof.

14. The method of claim 8, further comprising: providing, to the computing device of the user, a second request for a second cryptographic proof; receiving the second cryptographic proof from the computing device of the user, the cryptographic proof generated based on the public encryption key associated with a second attribute and an unencrypted version of a second shared secret stored on the computing device of the user; and verifying the second cryptographic proof that the user is associated with the second attribute based on the public encryption key associated with the second attribute and a second encrypted shared secret associated with the second attribute, wherein obtaining the decryption key is further responsive to verifying the second cryptographic proof.

15. A computer-readable storage medium having program instructions recorded thereon that, when executed by a processor, perform a method for recovering a decryption key comprising: receiving, from a computing device of a user, a request for decrypting a resource, the request specifying a policy identifier of a policy that specifies an identity authorized to access the resource and an attribute required to access the resource; obtaining the policy corresponding to the policy identifier from a policy map; determining the identity authorized to access the resource and the first attribute required to access the resource based on the policy; verifying that the user is associated with the identity; responsive to verifying that the user is associated with the identity, obtaining, from an attribute map, a public encryption key associated with the attribute and an encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute; providing, to the computing device of the user, a request for a cryptographic proof; and receiving the cryptographic proof from the computing device of the user, the cryptographic proof generated based on the public encryption key associated with the attribute and an unencrypted version of the shared secret stored on the computing device of the user; verifying the cryptographic proof that the user is associated with the attribute based on the public encryption key associated with the attribute and the encrypted shared secret associated with the attribute; responsive to determining that the cryptographic proof is valid, obtaining a decryption key for decrypting the resource.
16. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 15, wherein verifying the second identity comprises: obtaining a public encryption key associated with the user from an identity map; encrypting a nonce using the public encryption key; providing the encrypted nonce to the computing device of the user; receiving a decrypted nonce from the computing device of the user; determining that the decrypted nonce is the same as the nonce; and responsive to determining that the decrypted nonce is the same as the nonce, verifying that the user is associated with the identity.
17. The method of claim 15, wherein the attribute comprises at least one of: a clearance level of the user; a rank of the user within an organization; or a role of the user within the organization.
18. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 15, further comprising: encrypting the decryption key using a public encryption key associated with at least one of the user or the computing device of the user; and providing the encrypted decryption key to the computing device of the user.
19. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 15, further comprising: decrypting the resource utilizing the decryption key; and providing the decrypted resource to the computing device of the user.
20. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 15, wherein the resource comprises at least one of: a data file; a database object; structured data; unstructured data; or a data container.
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